

dated late in the Late Bronze Age, possibly in the transition to the Iron Age I. It was built on virgin soil, and abandoned after a short time, thus presenting a 'time capsule' of its period.

Unique elements here are the design of the city wall, the corridors and *tholoi*, the topographical location, and the abundance of small finds. Following a vain search for parallels in the southern Levant, the excavators were led to search for possible influence or origin in the western Mediterranean.

A possible origin of these characteristics may be found in the Nuraghic culture of the islands of Sardinia and Corsica. From 2000 BCE onwards a new culture emerged in Sardinia, characterized by piles of large stones designed as small mounds, with round inner rooms with corbelled domed roofs. These inner rooms, or artificial caves, are connected by inner corridors, and also roofed by a similar method. Until about 1500 BCE the buildings were what is called *proto-nuraghe*, whereas later they developed into large, castle-like constructions with a central tower.

The main architectural elements of this culture are corridors, the curved zigzag design of the outer lines of the *proto-nuraghe*, corbelled dome roofing and round stone huts. It seems that these elements were all found at el-Aḥwat (and possibly also in the south Carmel), but not in other areas of the southern Levant.

Bearing this in mind, it seems reasonable to suggest that these unique elements originated in the western Mediterranean. If so, we may be dealing here with the Shardana/Sherden Sea Peoples, a tribe or population that first appeared in the 14th century BCE, and remained in the Ancient Near East.

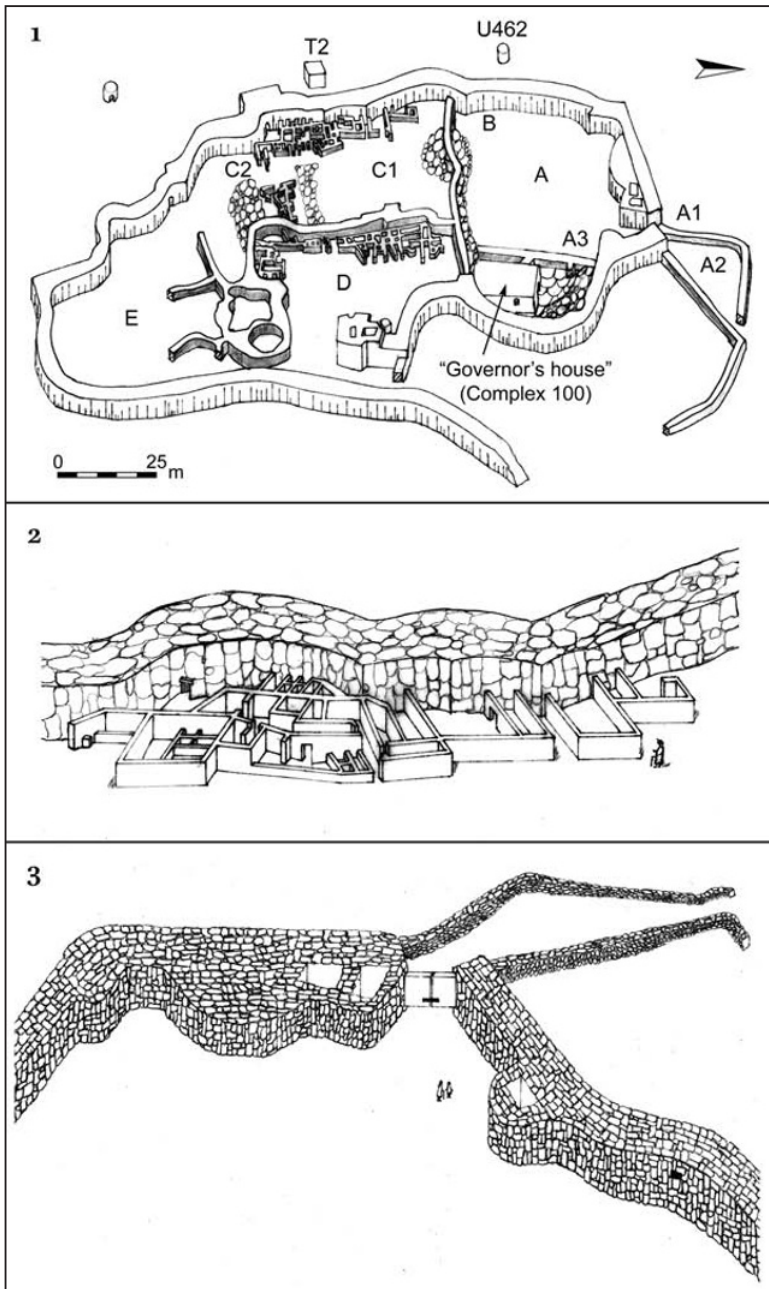
This hypothesis corroborates the evidence of the Egyptian sources (Papyrus Harris I, Wen-Amun, Amenope), which mention the settlement of Sea-Peoples in Canaan. According to Amenope, the Shardana might have settled in 'strongholds' north of the Yarkon River. El-Aḥwat can be suggested, in principle, as one of these sites. The prominent Egyptian influence can well be interpreted as a citadel settled by Shardana mercenaries under Egyptian command. For a different view see Finkelstein 2002.

Pottery: Iron I – 80%; Late Roman – 10%; Byzantine – 10%.

Identification: the place is identified as Ḥaroshet ha-Goyim, the place where Sisera settled (Judges 4:2 and 13); see Chapter 2.

Previous surveys: None.

Additional surveys: Gadot 1999a: site 15; 2006: site 15; Gadot and Tepper



59. Suggested reconstructions of the site (1), dwelling complex in Area C (2), and the gateway in Area A1-2 (3)(drawings by Osnat Gadir).

2009: site 325.

Additional Bibliography: Kühner 1989: site 357; Zertal 2001: 215-232; 2002a: 18-32; 2002b: 7-25; 2008b: 1563-1565; 2010; 2012; Finkelstein 2002; Ugas 2008; Winter 2008.



Site 29: 16-21/00/1

Khirbet Beit Muhammad es-Şaleḥ

Israel grid: 1605 2103	Soil quality: 4
UTM grid: 6982 5965	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 390 m a.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: 2
Name type: on map	Water source: 'Ein Haniyeh (no. 18), 1 km distant
Site type: small village	Road: Jatt–Megiddo (A1), 2.2 km distant
Area: 7 dunams (7000 sq. m)	Visibility: 8
Topography: high summit	Date of visit: Dec. 1997; 30 sherds
Rock type: Judah group	
Soil type: terra rossa	

A small village on a high plateau in the south-eastern part of Qatzir Plateau, about 1 km south-east of the centre of the village of 'Ar'arah

The site is composed of two distinct parts. In the northern one is a large courtyard house, about 30×40 m, including a courtyard, and various structures around it. The quality of construction is poor: small stones without plaster, with large stones for reinforcement placed in the walls here and there. The walls are about 0.5 m thick, and now stand to a height of about 1 m. A laid path bordered by stone walls meets the above complex from the south-east. The path enters the courtyard; its southern part is ruined.

The southern complex is located on a small raised area, about 100 m south of the former. It has a smaller courtyard house, with various structures around it. Two openings of rock-cut cisterns apparently belong to this complex.

There are few sherds. Apparently the site was established at the end of the 19th century AD, and was in existence for a few decades.

Pottery: Ottoman – 20%; Modern – 80%.

Previous surveys: None.

Site 30: 15-20/29/1

Tel Esur (in the British Survey – Tel Asawir)

Israel grid: 1521 2098	Soil type: alluvium
UTM grid: 6896 5957	Soil quality: 9
Elevation: 66 m a.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.	Cultivation: field crops and groves
Name type: ancient and appears on map	Cisterns: none
Site type: fortified tell on top of a vast settlement	Water source: Assawir Springs (no. 19), at site
Area: 20 dunams (2 ha) – tell; 800 dunams (80 ha) – preceding settlement	Road: Jatt–Megiddo (A1), next to site
Topography: alluvium plain	Visibility: 3
Rock type: alluvium cover, Mount Scopus group	Repeated visits 1975–1990; 200 sherds; seven excavation seasons (see Appendix F)

A fortified tell at the western entrance to Nahal 'Iron, close to 'Iron Junction and to Assawir Springs. The tell towers above the plain, and adjacent to it is a smaller tell, which contains remains of a smaller site.

The tell, which is elliptical in shape and is oriented north-south, is very visible. It rises about 10 m above the alluvium plain, and is fortified with a large Middle Bronze Age IIA city wall. East of the tell are the Assawir Springs, and next to them are remains of structures from the Roman period. In various emergency excavations that began in the 1970s, it became apparent that the tell stands on large ancient settlements dating from the Neolithic period until the Early Bronze Age I. This site is today entirely covered with alluvium.

The place called Assawir Springs was known in the Middle Ages as a gathering place. In the year 662 of the *Hajrah* (1264 CE) Sultan Baibars reached the place on his journey from Jaffa and Arsuf to Caesarea. The text relates: "On the morning of the second day, he himself [the Sultan] went out and sat by the workers in order to urge them on, and on that day four great mangonels were constructed as well as other smaller ones. The Sultan sent letters to his fortresses asking for mangonels, workmen and masons and he ordered the soldiers to make ladders, a number of which he assigned to each emir to transport. He then moved to the neighbourhood of 'Uyun al-Assawir, and in the late evening he ordered his men to put on their armour: towards morning he mounted and rode off in the direction of Caesarea, and what

happened we shall relate, if God Almighty wills." (Lyons 1971: 69).

Visits: On 12 April 1923 Albright visited and described the site as follows:

"Just outside the entrance to the Wadi 'Ara is the most interesting mound called Tell el-Asawir, 'Mound of Bracelets', perhaps so called from its perfectly round form, which is very noticeable when seen from the hills above. A prolonged search for pottery on the tell produced only sherds of the Bronze Age, showing clearly that the site was abandoned at the end of this age, or very early in the next. Professor Alt has made it certain that Tell el-Asawir was the site of the ancient Yehem, mentioned frequently in the texts of Tuthmosis III, who stopped there before entering the Wadi 'Ara on his way to attack Megiddo. Our sherds furnish additional support of this view, though the topographical indications of the Egyptian annals are in this case so exact as to render corroboration rather superfluous. The fact that Yehem was destroyed at the beginning of the Iron Age or shortly before suggests that it may have fallen into the hands of the marauding hordes of the Sea Peoples, when they invaded the coastal plain. We may possibly suppose that it was captured by the Sicilians, who did not feel themselves strong enough to rebuild a town so far from their base at Dor, and subject to constant Hebrew raids from the hills which overlooked the town from the east." (Albright 1923: 10).

In 1932 Mazar described the tell as "a large tell, Tel el-Assawir north of Karkur, one of the most important tells of the Sharon Valley and the most important crossroads of the entire region. Several important roads coming from the northeast, north and northwest meet next to Tel el-Assawir: the road passing from Megiddo in Nahal 'Iron (Wadi 'Arah) and the road connecting Acco Valley with the Sharon. At Tel el-Assawir the roads meet and unite in going south along the Via Maris." (Mazar 1976b: 150).

Cemeteries: In 1952 a cave south of 'Iron Junction was excavated by Dothan (1955). It contained a mass burial, including evidence of cremation, and a large number of vessels from the Early Bronze Age I.

In the 1960's Gophna (1978) excavated a tomb from the Middle Bronze Age II on the northern slope of the hill on which Kibbutz Barqai is situated. At the spot were found many burial offerings, among them ceramic vessels, weapons, and Egyptian scarabs.

In 1994–95 Yannai and Horowitz (1998) excavated on a hill east of the tell (Israel grid 1528/2097) 24 Intermediate Bronze Age shaft graves and two Early Bronze Age Ib burial caves. The shafts are round (1–1.5 m diam., 1.5–2 m deep) and at their bottoms were up to three openings (0.5 m

diam.). Most of the openings were blocked by large rolling tomb stones fixed in position by smaller stones. The openings led into one or two round or heart-shaped burial chambers (2–3 m diam.) with convex ceilings. The offerings included pottery vessels, flint blades, and metal artifacts (pins, awls, and lanceheads). More than one person was buried in each chamber, but the poor state of preservation of the bone does not enable determining sex or age. Four additional Intermediate Bronze Age tombs were excavated nearby by Horowitz (2000), and found to be empty.

The Early Bronze Age Ib caves have an oval burial chamber (4×3 m), and in each one were found hundreds of intact artifacts (500–600 items), including platters, bowls, jugs, juglets, and small jars. Noteworthy is the great number of grey burnished bowls, some laid on fenestrated pedestals; two items imported from Egypt, and one possibly from Mesopotamia. A great number of beads (of limestone, nacre, carnelian, haematite, and calcite), Egyptian alabaster pendants, a haematite button seal, a bone cylinder seal, daggers, lanceheads, and jewellery (rings, earrings, and bracelets) were also found. In each of the caves were hundreds of skeletons, but the poor state of preservation of the bones prevented the determination of sex and age. Nearby (Israel grid 1528/2098) a burial chamber (6×4 m) was excavated with two burial phases: Early Bronze Age I and Intermediate Bronze Age. About 80 intact artifacts were found from both phases, and human remains of at least 70 adults and ten children (Yannai 1996).

An Early Bronze Age burial cave (Gorzalczany and Sharvit 2007), three Intermediate Bronze Age caves (Mahajna 2006) and a quarry site were excavated south of Horbat Gilan and north of Tel Esur (Israel grid 1532/2098). The Early Bronze Age burial cave is of special interest: it is slightly oval (4×3.5 m) and the entry is via a corridor situated in its southern part. At least two burial phases were observed in the cave; some of the skeletons were articulated, and some were secondary burials. It seems to have been a family burial cave, because some of the skeletons were moved to the back of the cave in order to make room for new burials. The phases are dated to the Early Bronze Age Ib and Early Bronze Age II.

Yannai (2001) also excavated eight tombs at Harish Junction (Israel grid 1522/2086) south of Tel Esur. Seven have been dated to the Intermediate Bronze Age, and one was used in the Early and Middle Bronze Age periods. The graves are shaft graves with one to three chambers. In two of the shaft graves were found stone slabs blocking the chamber entrances. In an early stage of one of the graves were found 200 Early Bronze Age pottery vessels, including lamps, bowls, small jars, jugs, juglets, imported pottery from

Egypt (Naqada Culture), a donkey clay figurine carrying two containers on its back, beads, and a bronze dagger. The gifts from the Intermediate Bronze Age period found in the graves included pottery (bowls, jars, small jars, and jugs), flint blades, and bronze daggers and spears. The Middle Bronze Age II finds included pottery (dipper juglets, jars, and jugs) two spearheads and a sword blade.

Excavations: In 2001-2003 excavations were conducted at the tell under the direction of Zertal (2003). The stratigraphic situation that emerged from the dig is as follows:

Early Bronze Age: There is no doubt that the fortified tell was founded on the abandoned Early Bronze Age Ib village which spread out over large areas in the plain. The excavations did not reach this period.

Middle Bronze Age IIA-b: The tell seems to have been founded and fortified during this period.

Late Bronze Age: Only sparse remains were found in the areas concerned, mainly in Area C in the north-eastern part of the tel. Major discoveries from this period were made in the renewed excavation (and see Appendix G for a detailed description).

Iron Age I: Only pottery was found. It seems as if the tell itself was uninhabited in this period.

Beyond the perimeter of the tell, in the plain to the south-east, Yannai (2006) unearthed remains from the Chalcolithic and Early Bronze Age I periods. His stratigraphy and our description here are based upon the finds from the extensively explored Area B:

Stratum VII, Pottery Neolithic (Jericho IX): A single square (2×2 m) was excavated, in which were found sherds, flints, and faunal remains.

Stratum VI, Wadi Rabah: An open area, used for industry, burial, and refuse was exposed. A large number of sherds, flint, bones, and stone tools were found, alongside a *tabun* (oven) and two burials.

Stratum VC-VB, Early Chalcolithic: An open area with stone and plastered surfaces was exposed. Several installations were found, including a refuse pit containing cattle bones; a stone paved surface and a plastered pit; a pit lined and paved with stone slabs (1 m diameter, 0.7 m deep) was also found.

Stratum VA, Late Chalcolithic: A massive stone wall 1.5 m thick was exposed, which served perhaps as a wall surrounding the settlement.

Stratum IV, Late Chalcolithic period: Two rectangular structures were revealed. A complete building (18.5×4.5 m) was built above the massive

wall of Stratum VA. The walls, 0.5 m thick, were built of two rows of stones upon which were probably laid courses of mudbricks. Rows of stones found attached to the structure walls, inside and outside, were used as benches or work surfaces. Stone slabs integrated in the floor were used as column bases. An installation lined with stones (0.6 m diameter, 0.35 m deep) cut into the floor was used for drainage or placing storage vessels. Descending the entrance into the structure inner space was by two *in situ* steps. The hinge socket showed that the door opened inwards. The structure area is estimated to be 75 sq. m, and the total gross area including other domestic activity spaces is estimated at 250 sq. m.

The ceramic find from Strata V–IV included bowls, kraters, basins, jars, holemouth jars and pithoi, alongside pedestals, churns, and chalices. The flint finds included sickle blades, burins, scrapers, drills, and chisels. A bronze axe was found in Stratum IV.

Stratum III, Early Bronze Age Ia: Five oval domestic units were excavated. A typical unit consisted of an oval room (5×4 m) with walls averaging 0.35 m thick of two rows of stones that survived to a height of up to three courses. The floor was generally of beaten earth. Additional walls were built supporting the domestic units, and the space between them that included stone paved surfaces was used as activity areas.

Stratum II, Early Bronze Age Ib: Two architectural phases were identified. The earlier included oval structures, and the later had buildings with straight walls and rounded corners.

The ceramic finds from Strata III–II included grey-burnished bowls, jars, holemouth jars, pithoi, amphoriskoi, jugs, and juglets. The flint find contained Canaanite sickle blades, burins, scrapers, drills, and chisels.

Stratum I: sporadic remains from the Intermediate Bronze Age, Late Roman, Byzantine and Ottoman periods were found.

Another salvage excavation was conducted in 2008 at the north-eastern margins of the tell (Sa'id 2011b), and exposed a large Byzantine structure. Underneath it were found Early Bronze Age, Middle Bronze Age II, and Roman remains.

In 2010 a renewed excavation project was started at the site under the direction of S. Bar of the University of Haifa. For a detailed description of this large excavation see Appendix F.

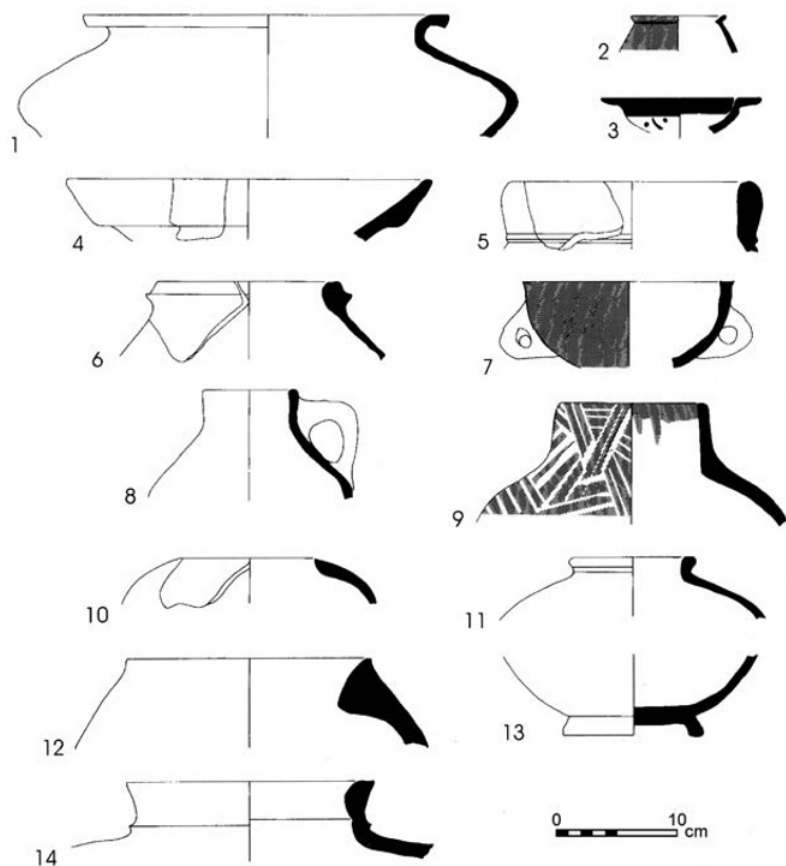
Pottery (Summary of the different surveys and excavations): Neolithic; Chalcolithic; Early Bronze I; Intermediate Bronze; Middle Bronze II; Late Bronze; Iron I–II; Persian–Early Roman; Late Roman; Byzantine; Ottoman.

Identification: The site was identified by Alt as Yehem, and by Mazar as Arubboth (I Kgs 4:10). We propose identifying it as the city of Djeft of Thutmosis III in his first campaign: see Chapter 2.

Previous surveys: Ne'eman 1990: site 1.

Additional surveys: Gadot 1999a: site 1; 2006: site 1.

Additional Bibliography: Conder and Kitchener 1882: 69; Mazar 1976b; 1976c; Gophna and Sussman 1969.



60. Pottery from Tel Esur: 1.CP, brn, LB II; 2.Bowl, rd slip, EB I; 3.Small bowl, lt, EB I (?); 4.Bowl, yel, Pers; 5.Pithos, brn, IA I; 6.CP, brn, IA II; 7.Bowl, lt, brn slip, EB I; 8.Jug, brn, IA II; 9.Jar, band slip, EB I; 10.HM, brn, EB I; 11.Jar, gr, Pers; 12.HM, brn, Chal; 13.Jug base, yel, MB II; Jar, yel, MB II.

Site 31: 15-20/39/1

Khirbet ez-Zebadneh (Kibbutz Barqai)

Israel grid: 1533 2091

UTM grid: 6910 5951

Elevation: 90 m a.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.

Name type: on map, but not ancient

Site type: kibbutz on medium-sized ruin

Area: 7 dunams (7000 sq. m)

Topography: edge of ridge above valley

Rock type: Mount Scopus group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 8

Water source: Assawir Springs (no. 19), 1 km distant

Road: Jatt–Megiddo (A1), 700 m distant

Visibility: 4

Date of visit: 1996; 48 sherds

A ruin on a ridge, descending westward to the coastal plain from the Umm el-Quṭuf Range. Kibbutz Barqai now stands on the ridge. North of the ridge is a wide valley, where Wadi Samantar spills out; south of it is the valley of another wadi where the road now runs to Umm el-Quṭuf and Harish.

In the central part of the ruin are remains of structures and worked stones. The place has been almost completely destroyed by the construction of the swimming pool and sporting installations of the kibbutz. Only



61. Stone house from the 19th century at Kh. ez-Zebadneh (Barqai), 1999.

Photo – M. Weinberg.

one stone building, two storeys high, remains from the Ottoman period, which now houses the museum of the kibbutz. Parts of walls and cisterns are scattered around the area. On the northern slope is one of the cemeteries of Tel Esur from Middle Bronze Age II; see Site 30.

The British Survey describes: "Khurbet ez Zebadneh – A very small hamlet near the edge of the plain, with springs on the north-west" (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 42).

Pottery: Late Roman – 20%; Byzantine – 30%; Early Moslem – 20%; Middle Ages – 20%; Ottoman – 10%.

Previous surveys: Ne'eman 1990: site 2.

Additional Bibliography: Roth 1958; Dauphin 1998, III: sites 83, 86.



Site 32: 15-20/49/1

Khurbet el-Hafour

Israel grid: 1543 2090

UTM grid: 6920 5950

Elevation: 126 m a.s.l., 30 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient, but not on map

Site type: abandoned village

Area: 10 dunams (1 ha)

Topography: forested slope

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 2

Water source: Assawir Springs
(no. 19), 2.5 km distant

Road: Jatt–Megiddo (A1), 1 km
distant

Visibility: 3

Date of visit: Feb. 1992; 19 sherds

An abandoned village on a ridge in a natural wood, about 1 km east of Kibbutz Barqai. It is located in the range surrounding the southern part of the valley of western Nahal 'Iron.

Within a natural wood of evergreen, oak and carob trees, about 30 structures with courtyards were found, made of small field stones, in a state of advanced ruin. The construction is very simple and includes lime plaster to hold the stones in place. The walls are now about 1 m high, and around them are fallen stones. Some of the lintels are made of ashlar, possibly in secondary use. Between the houses are narrow streets, but no public buildings were found. Cisterns and surfaces for collection of rainwater are visible. The southern part of the site has a cistern cut inside a winepress.

The village does not appear on the British Survey map, but does appear on the British Mandate map 1:20000 of 1942.

This is possibly the village that Abel (1951: 50) indicated when he wrote “a renovated village, west of ‘Arah”.

Pottery: Ottoman – 20%; Modern (20th century) – 80%.

Previous surveys: Ne’eman (1990: site 3) points to a ruin on a hill with remains of structures and a hewn cistern. Byzantine sherds were collected.



Site 33: 15-20/99/1

E.P. 342

Israel grid: 1598 2099

UTM grid: 6975 5960

Elevation: 342 m a.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: courtyard and structures

Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)

Topography: high point on rocky ridge

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 2

Water source: ‘Ein Barṭa’ah (no. 20), 600 m distant

Road: Jatt–Megiddo (A1), 2.5 km distant

Visibility: 8

Date of visit: Dec. 1997; 19 sherds

Structures on an elevation point of a ridge in the south-western part of Qatzir Plateau, about 900 m north of Sheikh Barṭa’ah.

On a rocky plateau, overlooking the coastal plain to the west and the Samaria Mountains to the south is a round courtyard built of stone. Its diameter is about 10 m, and the wall surrounding it is about 1 m wide. It is built of two rows of large stones with a fill of smaller stones. The western part of the courtyard has an opening 1 m wide and near it, to the north, is a small room built inside the courtyard with an opening to the south. Slightly north of it on a slope is a square structure, about 4×4 m, built of large stones. There is another similar structure about 30 m west of the courtyard. There is an especially sparse sherd scatter. It seems that the entire complex was used for agricultural purposes.

Ne’eman (1993) noted Byzantine period construction remains 400 m to

the north-west, including a wall 150 m long and 2 m thick, built pens, agricultural structures, a winepress, and two cisterns.

Pottery (Summary of the different surveys and excavations): Persian; Hellenistic; Early Roman; Byzantine.

Previous surveys: None.



Site 34: 15-20/58/1

Khirbet eṭ-Ṭawileh

Israel grid: 1550 2085

UTM grid: 6928 5945

Elevation: 170 m a.s.l., 30 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient and appears on map

Site type: small village on ruin

Area: 2 dunams (2000 sq. m) – ancient core

Topography: hilltop

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 20

Water source: Assawir Springs (no. 19), 3.2 km distant

Road: Wadi Samantar–Baqā (C14), 1 km distant

Visibility: 6

Repeated visits 1982-1988; 50 sherds

A small ruin on a prominent hilltop in the hilly area between Kibbutz Barqai and Barṭa'ah, about 3.5 km west of the latter. Today it is situated on the hilltop of a modern village.

New construction has almost entirely destroyed the few ancient remains, among them houses made of stones and plaster, burial caves, quarrying and agricultural installations. A few sherds are scattered over the hilltop and slopes.

The place was apparently a Roman-Byzantine farm, a subsidiary of the Umm el-Quṭuf site. It does not appear on the British Survey map.

Pottery: Late Roman – 23%; Byzantine – 14%; Early Moslem – 2%; Middle Ages – 10%; Ottoman – 30%; Modern – 21%.

Previous surveys: None.

Additional surveys: Ne'eman 1990: site 17 (mentions only quarrying).

Additional Bibliography: Dauphin 1998, III: site 90

Site 35: 15-20/58/2

Khirbet Umm el-Quṭuf

Israel grid: 1558 2082	Soil type: terra rossa
UTM grid: 6936 5943	Soil quality: 6
Elevation: 183 m a.s.l., 40 m a.s.a.	Cultivation: olive groves (partial)
Name type: ancient	Cisterns: about 50 (in ancient core)
Site type: village on ruin	Water source: Bir Isyar (no. 140), 2.8 km distant
Area: 8 dunams (8000 sq. m) – ancient core	Road: Wadi Samantar–Baqa (C14), 1.2 km distant
Topography: two hilltops at edge of ridge	Visibility: 7
Rock type: Judah group	Repeated visits 1985-1989; 45 sherds

A modern village on a medium-sized ruin in the hilly area between Kibbutz Barqai and the village of Barṭa'ah, looking east toward the valley of Barṭa'ah. The village is located on a short ridge that has two hilltops, and the ancient core is on the higher, western hilltop.

Some parts of the ancient buildings, apparently from the Roman-Byzantine period, have been preserved within the modern construction. It is still possible to see walls made of large cut stones, cisterns, burial caves, and rock-cut agricultural installations. A few houses from the Ottoman period have also been preserved. The new construction has rendered most of the lines of the ancient settlement indistinct, and its plan is difficult to discern. There are also agricultural installations on the hill slopes. Today the new road to Harish by-passes the village to the west.

The village does not appear in the 1596 census or in Medieval sources. In the British Survey it appears only as “ruined walls” (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 64).

Pottery: Hellenistic – 7%; Early Roman – 20%; Late Roman – 15%; Byzantine – 15%; Early Moslem – 3%; Middle Ages – 25%; Ottoman – 10%; Modern – 5%.

Previous surveys: None.

Additional surveys: Ne'eman 1990: site 18.

Additional Bibliography: Dauphin 1998, III: site 94.

Site 36: 16-21/30/1

Khirbet Umm er-Riḥan

Israel grid: 1635 2100

UTM grid: 7012 5962

Elevation: 440 m a.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.

Name type: on map as historic site

Site type: large settlement (small town)

Area: 35 dunams (3.5 ha)

Topography: mountainous plateau

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: about 30

Water source: 'Einot Sheri'ah (no. 14), 1.8 km distant

Road: Mu'allaqah–Jenin (C17), at site

Visibility: 5

Visits: 1988, 1990; site excavated by Bar-Ilan University.

A large ruin (town) on a flat plateau in the area of a high range and on the watershed to the south of Nahal 'Iron, about 2 km south of Mei-'Ami. To the east, tributaries of Nahal Zavdon descend from the area of the site, and to the west, tributaries of Wadi Samantar descend. The Ta'anach-Ya'bad road passes close to the ruin. The excavators assumed that the site connected to the Roman road from Nahal 'Iron to the Roman town of Ginae (contemporary Jenin).

The site was excavated twice: by Yeivin (1973: 147–149), and by Bar-Ilan University (Dar et al. 1986). This entry, based primarily on the report of the Bar-Ilan expedition comprises (a) description of the site, (b) results of the Bar-Ilan excavations, (c) Yeivin's excavation, (d) dating of the site, and (e) conclusions.

(a) Description: The place, on a high plain, is an enclosed settlement, the shape of which was determined in the Late Roman period. It includes about 100 courtyard houses, with a network of streets and lanes connecting them. All the masonry is of hard limestone ashlars, sometimes with coarse dressing of the margins. The settlement was surrounded, not by a city wall, but by the outer walls of the houses that created a type of enclosure. This settlement had at least 15 entrances, with no city gates. The outline can be seen in the north and west, but in the south it has been disrupted by Arab building of the last few generations. Clear evidence of division into quarters was not found, but the Bar-Ilan expedition is convinced that there was such a division.

(b) Results of the excavations: The houses are not connected to each other, each one having an opening on to the street. The courtyard houses

that were measured (some were excavated) are well built. In most of the buildings there are three to five rooms on the ground floor, an inner courtyard and additional storeys. The number of rooms in each architectural complex ranges from six to ten.

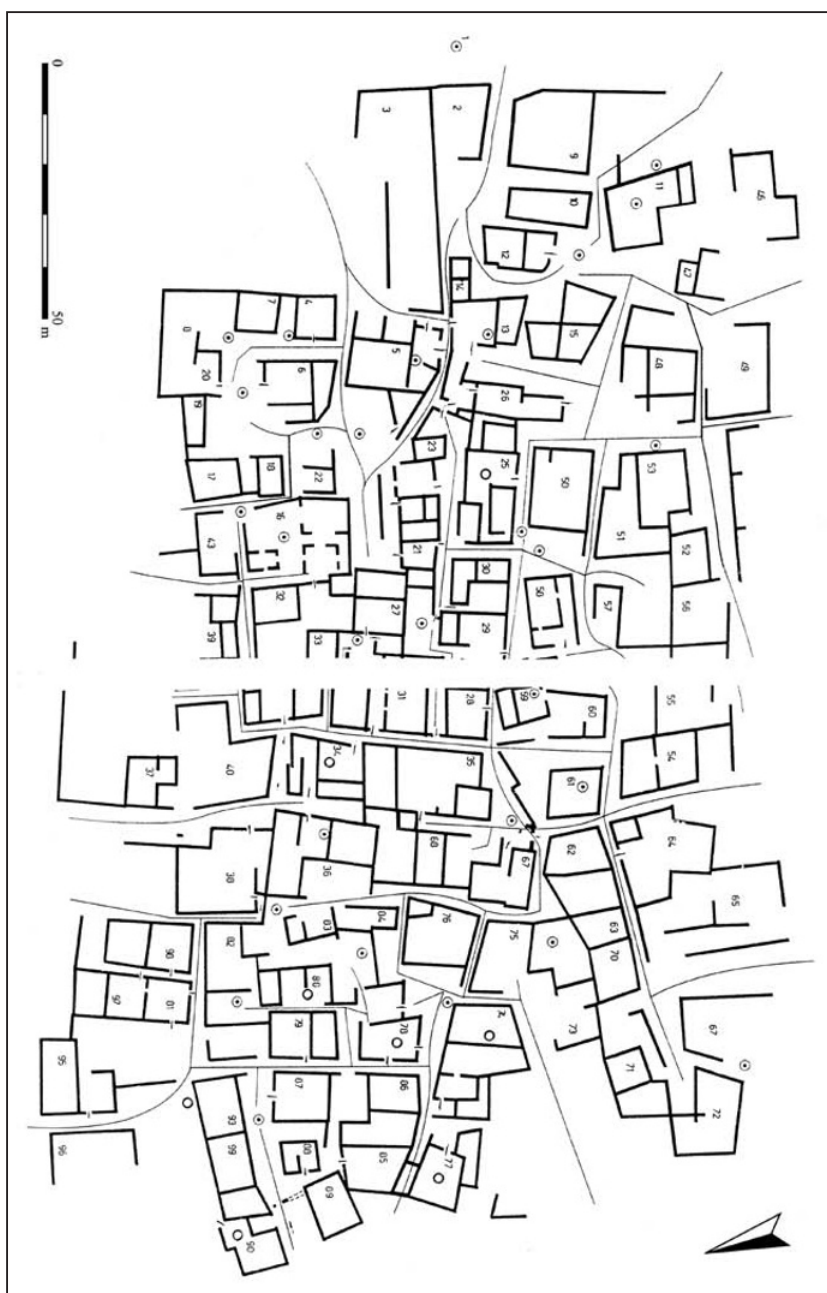
Description of one of the courtyard houses: Complex 81 (a domestic dwelling): It is situated in the north-west of the settlement, having an area of 100 sq. m (9×11 m). The walls, about 1 m thick, and made of large stones, were preserved to a height of about 2.3 m. The structure had three openings, and the main entrance was on the south side. A staircase led up to the second floor, and the roofing was supported with round and square stone pillars. On the pillars were stone and wooden beams. Other houses were similar, with some differences in size and design.

Four main streets run from north to south, and two streets from east to west, with a network of narrow lanes in between. The average width of a street was 2 m. Some of the streets and lanes were blocked off, possibly for security purposes. Some of the entrances were also fortified or blocked off by various means, apparently toward the end of the settlement's existence. The water supply was based on 25 cisterns for collecting rainwater, and two large reservoirs, apparently for watering livestock. Protection of the settlement depended not on a city wall, but on fortified towers in various places in the site. A fortified 'enclosure' was discovered in the north-west, near the entrance, and also, with less certainty, in the north-east. Close to the eastern entrances, Tower no. 4 was found, as well as another tower 200 m north-east of the site. The latter was 6.8×7.2 m, and it was preserved to a height of 2 storeys. In excavating the tower, it was found to have been built in the 1st century CE, and to have existed until the 3rd century CE.

Within the settlement, between six and eight oil presses were discovered. In Press no. 25, a lower crushing stone, 2 m in diameter, was found, cut from the virgin rock.

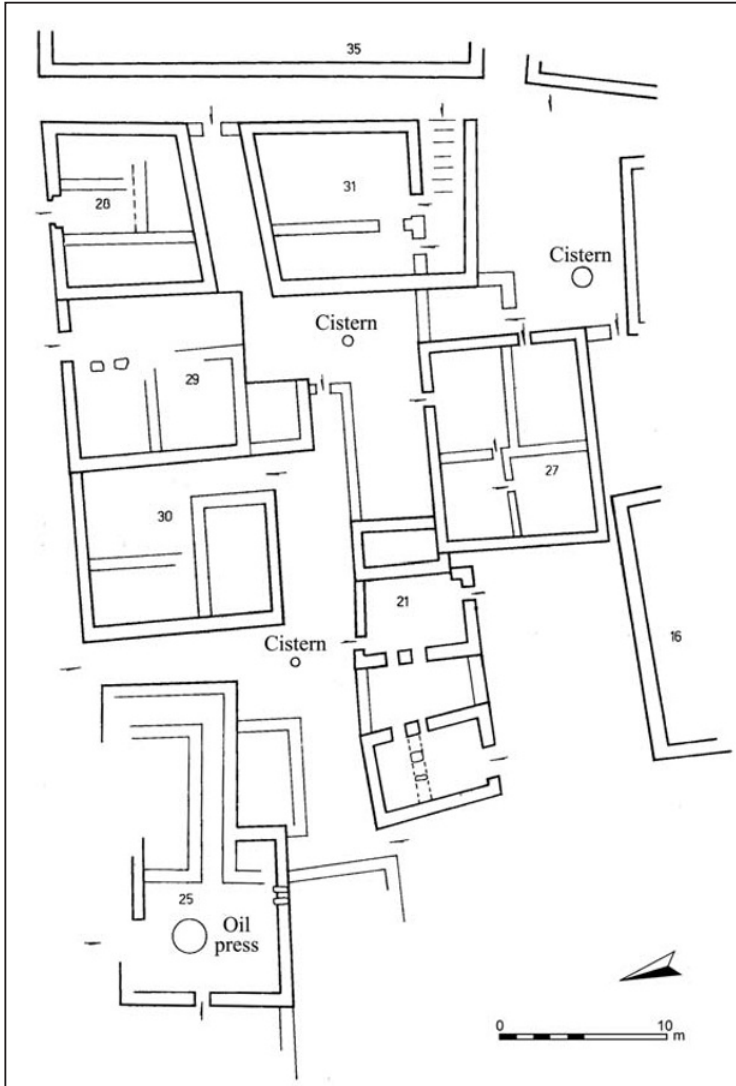
Part of the cultivated land of the town, an area of 10 sq. km, was also investigated. Over 100 field towers were discovered, and some were excavated. Farmhouses were also found (recorded as separate sites), as well as wine and oil presses, an open reservoir, ancient roads, terraces, and piles of stones.

(c) **Yeivin's excavations:** In 1969 Yeivin (1973: 147–149) conducted emergency excavations on two structures, which turned out to be a mausoleum with crypt graves. In one structure two decorated sarcophagi were found, one of which was adorned with a relief depicting a gateway and two pomegranates hanging from its sides. Under the left pomegranate was a flask,



62. The site at Umm er-Riḥān – general plan (Dar et al. 1986: fig. 2).

and on each side was the main decoration of rings, while to its right was a palm tree. On the narrow side of the coffin was a rose relief within a circle, between two stylized pillars. The second structure was 15×15m, built of large stones, containing two storeys of niches with ten niches in each level. No sarcophagi were found in this structure. The pottery in these structures was from the 3rd and 4th centuries CE.



63. Plan of blocks of houses at Umm er-Riḥan (Dar et al. 1986: fig. 5).

(d) Dating: The work of the Bar-Ilan expedition was partial, and was based on limited excavations, but their chronological summary is of interest, and reads in part (Dar et al. 1986: 119-120):

"A. The beginning of the settlement in the area was in the 7th-6th centuries BCE. During this period two farms were built; the site itself was not yet settled, but the agricultural areas were exploited...

B. During the Persian Period the settlement itself was founded and cultivation of the surrounding lands commenced...

C. During the Hellenistic Period the settlement continued its development...and the agricultural roads were built.

D. ... During the Early Roman Period the peaceful growth of the site and building of the farms continued.

E. During the 3rd century CE the settlement was abandoned. We have no reasonable explanation for its abandonment..."

(e) Conclusions: The Umm Riḥan project is one of the few that has studied rural Roman settlement in Samaria. A settlement of this size, in existence during the Early and Later Roman periods, would have been connected with the Narbatah District (see description of Khirbet el-Ḥamam, Site 146), and it is possible that it was destroyed or severely damaged during the 1st century CE.

Description of the British Survey: "Traces of ruins; drafted stones of good sized masonry, with a rustic boss. West of it in the valley is a ruined watch-tower." (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 64). In the opinion of the Bar-Ilan expedition, the British surveyors did not visit the site (Dar et al. 1986: 47) but this supposition is unreasonable, and the short description fits most of the descriptions of the exceptionally laconic style of Conder and Kitchener.

In 1998 a salvage excavation was conducted south and east of the site by Maharian (2000a). Seven towers; rounded, square, and square with an attached yard, served for agricultural produce storage or for temporary residence of the farmers, possibly from Umm er-Riḥan. The find has been dated to the 4th-7th centuries CE.

Pottery: Hellenistic – 20%; Early Roman – 30%; Late Roman – 40%; Byzantine – 10%.

Previous surveys: Dar et al 1986.

Additional Bibliography: Dauphin 1998, III: site 78; Salem 2006: site 340.

Site 37: 15-20/69/1

Khirbet Madar

Israel grid: 1567 2091

UTM grid: 6943 5951

Elevation: 177 m a.s.l., 60 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient, and appears
on map

Site type: fortress

Area: 2 dunams (2000 sq. m)

Topography: hilltop

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 4

Cultivation: olive grove

Cisterns: 2

Water source: 'Ein Barṭa'ah (no. 20),
3 km distant

Road: Wadi Samantar–Baqa (C14),
next to site

Visibility: 8

Date of visit: Dec. 1991; 30 sherds

A fortress on a hilltop that dominates the environs in the hilly area south-east of Nahal 'Iron, about 2 km west of the village of Barṭa'ah.

The site consists of two main parts:

1. A supporting wall surrounding the summit of the hill at a radius of about 50 m from the summit. The wall is preserved, especially in the south, where it stands 2 m high, and in the east. In the north and west it is less well preserved.
2. A square, fortress-like structure, 37×37 m. The wall surrounding the structure is about 1.2 m wide, and is built of two rows of large stones that are worked on their outer side. This wall has been well preserved on all sides, except for the north-west corner, which was ruined by a lime furnace, and part of the southern side.

Inside the square structure were found remains of several small structures, some square and some rectangular, built exactly like the wall surrounding them. These were part of the system of rooms that surrounded the central courtyard. The entrance to the fortress was apparently on the south side.

To the east of the external support wall is a somewhat rounded structure, about 3 m in diameter. Its date of construction is unclear, but it seems to be later than the original building. About 3 m north of the northern wall of the fortress is a later cut pool, 9×12 m and 0.7 m deep today. Remains of red plaster are clearly visible.

Two cisterns were found in the east and west, and later construction activity (modern?) was carried out in various places in the ancient structure.

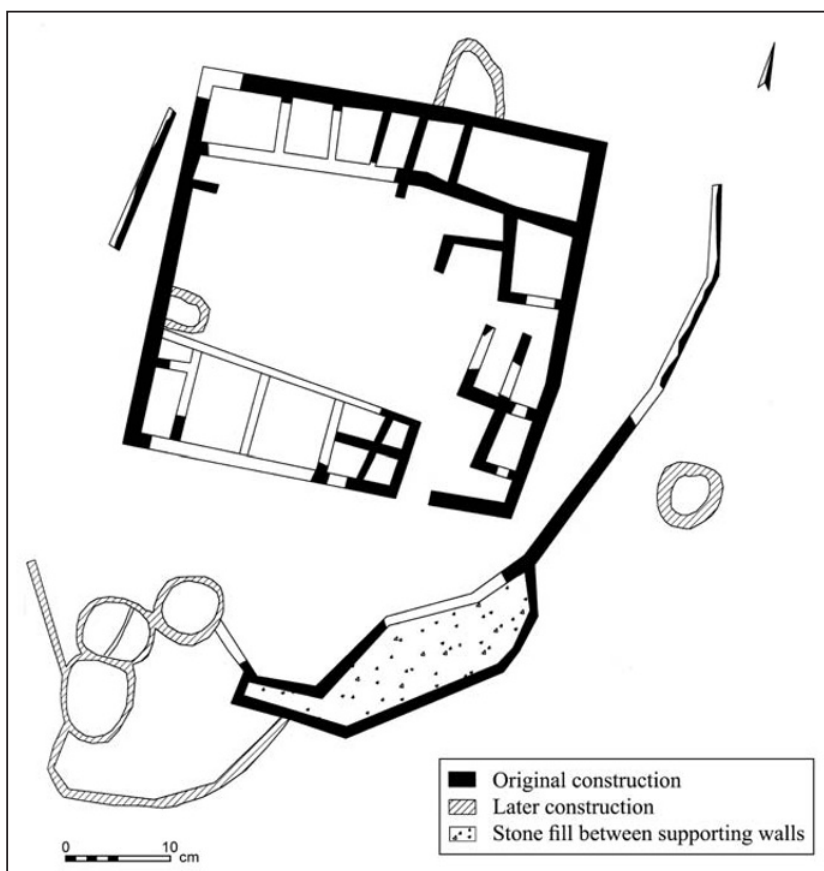
The high location, the design, quality of construction, and the plan itself indicate that this was a Roman courtyard fortress which was apparently connected to the road that passes close by (C14).

In the British Survey the site appears under the name Abu Madwar, without description.

Pottery: Early Roman – 10%; Late Roman – 80%; Modern – 10%.

Previous surveys: Ne'eman 1990: site 6.

Additional Bibliography: Dauphin 1998, III: site 84.

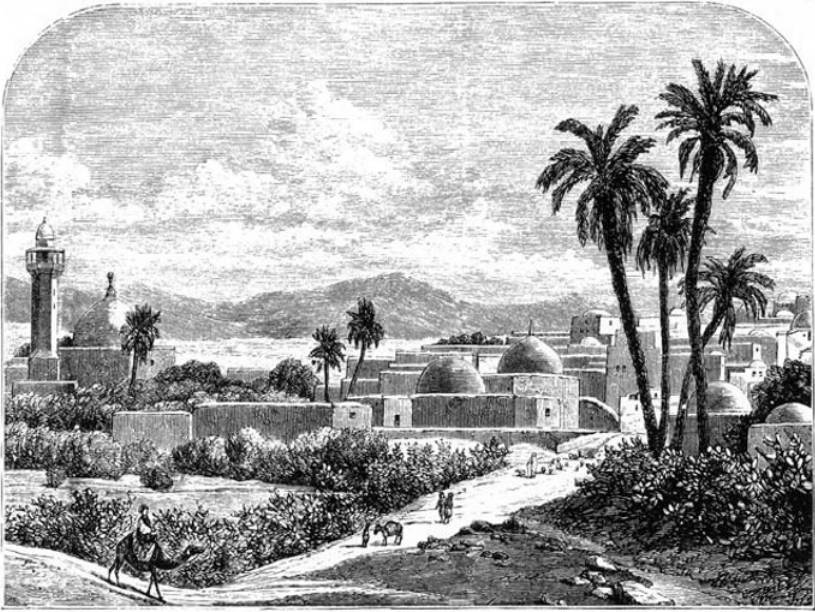


64. The Roman fortress at Kh. Madar – general plan, 1992.

CHAPTER FOUR

THE FRINGES OF JEZREEL
AND THE TA'ANACH HILLS

LANDSCAPE UNIT 23



65. Jenin, etching from *Those Holy Fields*, by S. Manning (London, 1873).

Site 38: 17-21/04/1

Tel Ta'anach (on British Survey map: Taanuk)

Israel grid: 1709 2142	Soil quality: 8
UTM grid: 7085 6006	Cultivation: groves
Elevation: 182 m a.s.l., 40 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: about 20
Name type: ancient and appears on map	Water source: 'Ein Ti'inik (no. 6), at site
Site type: fortified tell	Road: Jenin–Megiddo (A2), next to site
Area: about 80 dunams (8 ha)	Visibility: 3
Topography: valley fringes	Repeated visits 1980–1987;
Rock type: alluvium and pebbles	110 sherds
Soil type: terra rossa	

A large tell on the south-western fringes of the Jezreel Valley, near the Jenin–Megiddo road, close to 'Ein Ti'inik, its water source. Near the tell is the village of Ti'inik and the exit of the internal road which leads to the Ya'bad road (C16). The tell has been excavated by three expeditions, and some of the finds have been published.

Excavations: In 1902–1904 it was excavated for the first time by Sellin (1904). Long trenches were dug, but the city fortifications were not found. Twelve documents written in Akkadian were discovered: eight letters and four lists of names. Sellin identified four strata at the site: I – 15th–14th centuries BCE; II – 13th–9th centuries BCE, including the 'eastern fortification' and most of the graves; III – 8th–6th centuries BCE, where the 'incense altar' was found; IV – 11th–12th centuries CE, a fortified Medieval palace.

Lapp (1964) excavated a section in the south-west. The Early Bronze Age II–III fortification line became clear (four strata), postdated by a 'camp' from the Middle Bronze Age II period (c. 1700 BCE). The 'western building' (c. 1600 BCE) was defined as an aristocrat's house. In this period the city grew and continued to exist until the end of the period. Many graves were found, including burials of children in jars.

The city was destroyed or damaged, possibly during the campaign of Thutmose III at the beginning of the 15th century BCE, and afterwards it was sparsely populated. Another Akkadian tablet was found, dated to 1450 BCE and a tablet in Ugaritic was found in the destruction stratum of the 12th century (c. 1125 BCE). In the 10th century BCE the city was again destroyed, possibly during Shishak's military campaign. In this stratum an

elaborate incense burner was found, as well as a sacrificial building with many finds. During Iron Age II, the Persian and the later periods (Roman onwards) the tell was sparsely and sporadically inhabited.

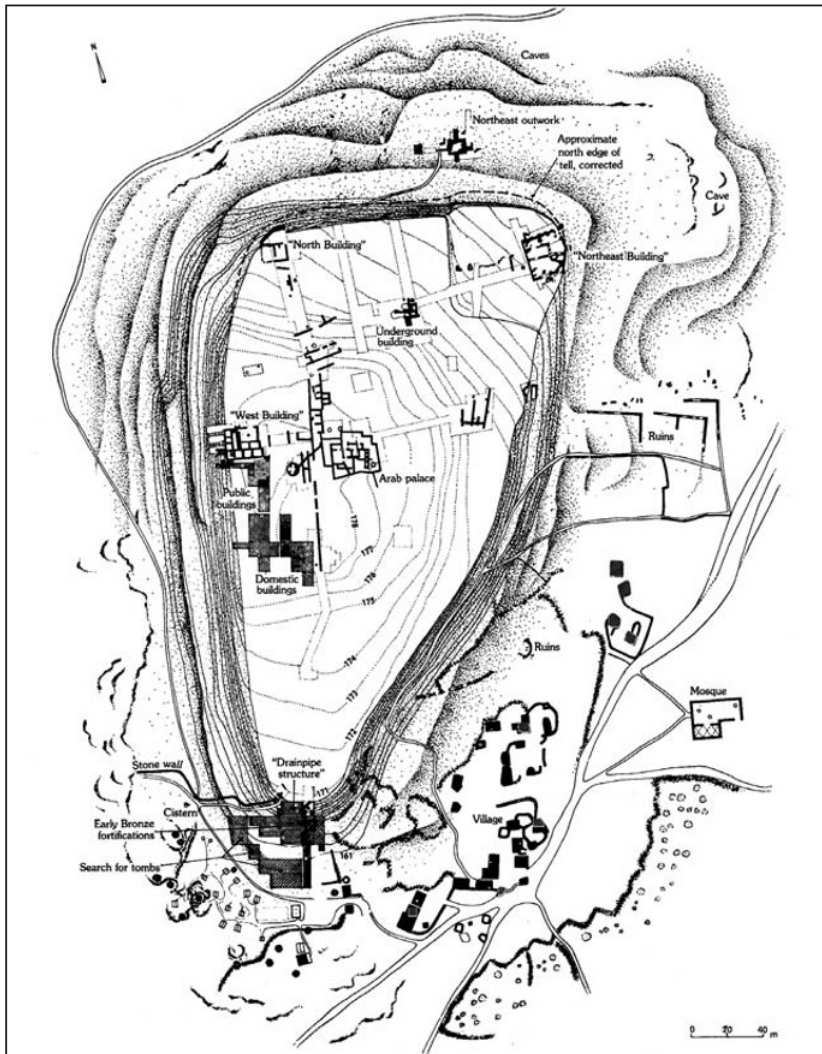
Tablets written in Akkadian from Sellin's excavations (Glock 1993: 1431–1432): These include eight letters to a local king, and administrative records. Two of the letters were sent by Amenhotep, an Egyptian functionary from Gaza, to the ruler of Ta'anach, requesting chariots, soldiers, captives, and taxes. A person named Ahima requests weapons and chariot wheels. Ahli-Teshub promises to return 50 silver shekels, requests wood and myrrh, and wants to marry off a slave woman. The language is Akkadian, but there is frequent usage of West Semitic terms. Between 60 and 80% of the names are Western Semitic and 20 % are Indo-European or Hurrian-Anatolian. The governor of Ta'anach was named RI-WA-shur. The entire archive (including the letter found in Lapp's dig) was dated to the first half of the 15th century BCE.

Ta'anach in the Bible and other sources: The city appears in most of the Egyptian sources from the 15th century: of Thutmose III, the el-Amarna letters (EA 248), and in Shishak's list. In the Bible the city is included in the territory of Manasseh (Josh 17:12), and not far from the site of the battle between Barak Ben Avinoam and Sisera (Judg 4-5) took place. In the list



66. A bird's eye view of Tel Ta'anach, looking north – 1997. At the bottom of the photo is the village of Ti'inik. Photo: M. Weinberg.

of the defeated kings of Canaan (Josh 12:21) it appears between Achshaf and Megiddo, but is included among the cities that were not conquered by Manasseh (Judg 1:28). Afterwards it became one of the Levite cities (Josh 21:25), belonging to the fifth district of Solomon (I Kgs 4:12). The place is mentioned twice in the Onomasticon (nos. 492, 504 – Taylor 2003): “Today it is at the fourth mile from Legio” and “a very large village, three miles’ dis-



67. Plan of Tel Ta'anach, and principal remains (Glock 1993: 1429).

tance from Legio". The reference may be to the village of Ti'inik (see Site 40).

Pottery (according to the excavation finds): Early Bronze II-III; Middle Bronze IIb-c; Late Bronze I-II; Iron I; Iron II; Persian (few); Middle Ages. Salam (2006: site 321) also notes Hellenistic and Early Moslem sherds in Ta'anach.

Previous surveys: None.

Additional Bibliography: Albright 1944; Helck 1962: 124, 133-134, 164, 174, 189, 197, 258-260, 274, 516, 519-520; Rast 1978; Glock 1992; 1993; Finkelstein et al. 2006: site 82; For full bibliography until 2005 see: *NEAEHL* 4: 1433; 5: 2114.



Site 39: 16-21/82/1

Umm ed-Duwaleh

Israel grid: 1693 2129	Soil quality: 5
UTM grid: 7069 5983	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 180 m a.s.l., 30 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: 1
Name type: ancient, but not on map	Water source: 'Ein Ti'inik (no. 6),
Site type: enclosure	2 km distant
Area: 3 dunams (3000 sq. m)	Road: Ya'bad-Ta'anach (C16),
Topography: low ridge	next to site
Rock type: Judah group	Visibility: 5
Soil type: terra rossa	Date of visit: Nov. 1997; 29 sherds

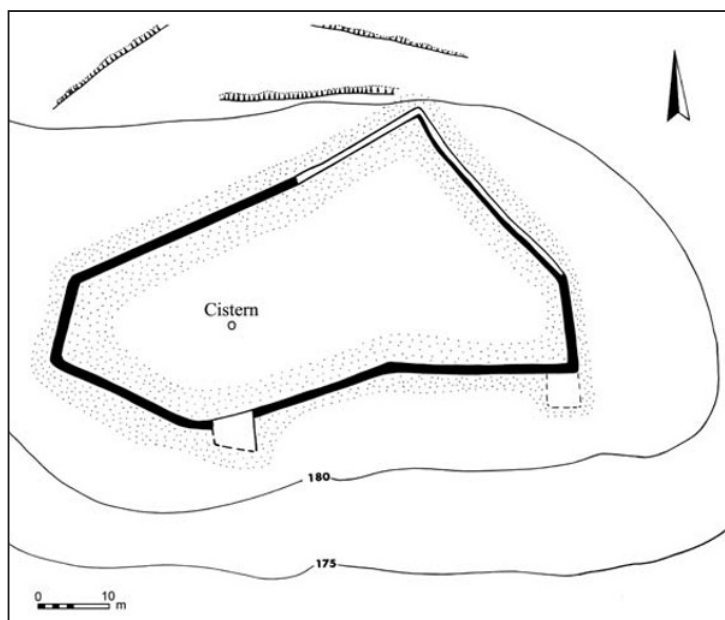
An enclosure on a ridge in the hilly area about 2 km south-west of Tel Ta'anach. The road from 'Anin to Ti'inik runs just south of the site.

The enclosure is irregular in shape. A 1 m thick wall, built of two rows of medium-sized stones, surrounds the flat summit of the hill on which the enclosure is situated. The wall creates a levelled summit. In at least two places constructions, which appear to be supports due to the slope, protrude from the enclosure. In the centre is a cistern. In the surrounding area are many pits for a rock-cut vineyard (*dakhadikh*).

Pottery: Persian – 50%; Byzantine – 50%.

Previous surveys: None.

Bibliography: Finkelstein et al. 2006: site 5.



68. Plan of the site at Umm ed-Duwaleh, 1997.



Site 40: 17-21/03/1

Ti'inik (on British Survey map Taanuk)

Israel grid: 1708 2138

UTM grid: 7082 6003

Elevation: 150 m a.s.l., 30 m b.s.a.
(of tell Ta'anach)

Name type: ancient and on map

Site type: village at foot of tell

Area: 5 dunams (5000 sq. m)

Topography: ravine

Rock type: alluvium and pebbles

Soil type: brown forest and alluvium

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: about 50 (in village)

Water source: 'Ein Ti'inik (no. 6),
at site

Road: Jenin–Megiddo (A2), next to
site

Visibility: 5

Repeated visits 1980–1983; 35 sherds

A small village on the southern slopes of Tel Ta'anach. In the ancient core are several houses built in Ottoman style, with a Roman-Byzantine sherd scatter. It is difficult to determine whether their origin is the village or the

tell, but the former seems more likely.

The place is mentioned twice in the Onomasticon (nos. 492, 504; Taylor 2003), as “a very large village three miles away from Legio” and “in the fourth mile from Legio”. In the Middle Ages it was known as *Casale Taanoc* and as *Thanis*. Crusader Ta’anach was connected with the Diocese of the Galilee (Nazareth) (Beyer 1936: 10; 1940: 195).

In 1596 there were 13 Moslem taxpayers who paid tax on a third of its crops for a sum of 7000 *aqia*. Of this, 4060 *aqia* were for wheat and 1600 *aqia* were for barley as well as 1040 *aqia* for olives (Hütteroth and ‘Abdul-fattah 1977: 159).

Guérin (1969b: 226–228; 14 June 1870) gives a detailed description: “At 8:30 we rode north along Wadi ej-Jammus. It was adorned with bushes. At 8:50 we reached Ta’anach. As of now the village is limited to ten miserable homes on an elongated flank of a hill. In front, buildings covered the southern slope of this hill [he apparently refers to Tel Ta’anach – A.Z.] and all its back, as shown by the countless quantities of sherds scattered on the ground and all sorts of building stones encountered with every step; the largest stones must have been transferred to some other place. Down from the village is a small mosque, and it is said that previously it was a Christian church. Indeed, it is aligned east-west, and all its stones came from ancient buildings. Some of them, for example, the gateway lintels, are decorated with carvings. Further on, in the plain, are several ancient cisterns hewn in the rock, and a well known as Bir Ti’inik. Ti’inik is ancient Ta’anach, whose name was preserved in the name of this little village without any change whatsoever.” [translated from French, A.Z.].

In the British Survey it is described as: “Tannuk...a small village, which stands on the south-east side of the great Tell or mound of the same name at the edge of the plain. It has olives on the south, and wells on the north, and is surrounded with cactus hedges. There is a white dome in the village. The rock on the sides of the Tell is quarried in places, the wells are ancient, and rock-cut tombs occur on the north near the foot of the mound. This place is the Taanach of the Bible (Josh. xii. 21)” (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 46).

In 1931 there were 64 residents and 15 inhabited houses (Vilnay 1968: 437). According to Grossman (without documentation), the residents can be divided into those who came from Silet el-Hartiyeh, from ‘Arrabeh and the Bet Nattif region (Grossman 1986: 349).

In 1985–1987 archaeological excavations were conducted by Glock within the framework of ethno-archaeological digs of the Mamluk-Ottoman village (see details in Ziadeh 1995; Ziadeh-Seely 1995).

Pottery (Summary of the different surveys and excavations): Roman; Byzantine; Middle Ages; Ottoman.

Previous surveys: None.

Additional Bibliography: Dauphin 1998, III: site 45.



Site 41: 17-21/12/1

Silet el-Khartiyeh (on British Survey map: Sily)

Israel grid: 1717 2128	Soil quality: 7
UTM grid: 7093 5992	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 150 m a.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: about 150 (in village)
Name type: ancient and on map	Water source: 'Ein Ti'inik (no. 6),
Site type: Arab village on ruin	1.4 km distant
Area: about 10 dunams (1 ha)	Road: Jenin–Megiddo (A2), 500 m
Topography: moderate hill	distant
Rock type: Judah group	Visibility: 4
Soil type: brown forest	Repeated visits 1980-1985; 50 sherds

A large village on a hill in the western fringes of the Jezreel Valley, 1.3 km south-east of Tel Ta'anach and about 500 m west of the Jenin–Megiddo road.

From the ancient core of the village only remnants of a few houses remained, which include ancient dressed stones, burial cave openings, etc. The core is in the centre of the modern village, close to the tomb of Sheikh 'Abdallah.

For reasons that are unclear, the village does not appear in the 1596 census, and it may have been counted together with Ti'inik. Guérin (1969b: 225–226) describes, "... we reached Sileh, a large village of 1000 inhabitants. It is surrounded by fig, olive and pomegranate orchards, and some grape vines. In the valley separating two of the quarters, there is a 'Valy' devoted to Sheikh Hassan, in front of which stand three palm trees" [translated from French, A.Z.].

In the British Survey it appears as: "A good-sized village, well-built of stone, with a spring and cisterns. There are rock-cut winepresses on the west, and olives and figs around. A palm plantation grows close to this village" (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 45).

In the 1931 census there were 1254 residents and 295 inhabited houses (Vilnay 1968: 301).

According to Grossman (1986: 349, without documentation), the village was apparently founded in the 17th–18th century CE, and its residents came from S'eir (Jarrrdat), 'Arureh and Mazar in the Gilboa.

Pottery: Roman – 20%; Byzantine – 20%; Early Moslem – 10%; Middle Ages – 20%; Ottoman – 15%; Modern – 15%.

Previous surveys: None.



Site 42: 17-21/22/1

Khirbet Yannun

Israel grid: 1727 2121

UTM grid: 7103 5985

Elevation: 100 m a.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient, but not on map

Site type: medium-sized ruin

Area: 6.8 dunams (6800 sq. m)

Topography: plateau and valley
fringes

Soil type: alluvium

Soil quality: 8

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: none

Water source: 'Ein Ti'inik (no. 6),
2.5 km distant

Road: Jenin–Megiddo (A2),
next to site

Visibility: 4

Date of visit: Oct. 1979; Jan. 1980;
187 sherds

A medium-sized ruin in the fringes of the Jezreel Valley, near the Megiddo–Jenin road, north of the place where the road to el-Yamun branches off this road.

The site extends over ploughed cultivated areas in the valley fringes. The cultivated land is divided into large plots by stone walls which include building stones of the site. Due to the cultivation and ploughing, no architectural remains could be discerned, but there are a great many sherds scattered over the area. Judging by the amount of pottery and other finds, this must have been a site of considerable importance in the Jezreel Valley fringes.

Pottery: Intermediate Bronze – 5%; Middle Bronze IIa – 10%; Middle Bronze IIb – 50%; Late Bronze – 30%; Iron I – 5%.

The pottery includes a wealth of material from the Middle and Late Bronze Ages, including imported ware from Mycenae and Cyprus, and

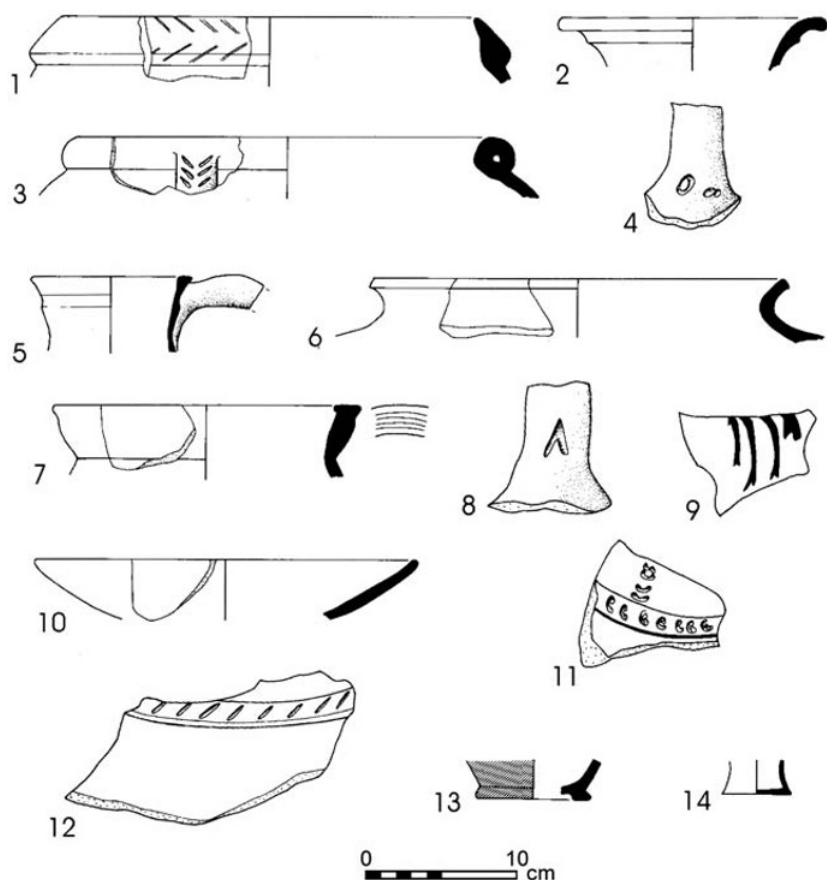
items of the 'chocolate on white ware' and 'bichrome' local families.

Identification: It is proposed to identify this site as Gitirimmunima of Letter 250 of the el-Amarna letters: see Chapter 2.

Special find: a bronze figurine of a seated reigning god with arms extended to accept an offering. It wears a high Anatolian tiara and a gown. See Appendix E.

Previous surveys: Porath 1968: no. 5.

Bibliography: Helck 1962: 197; Zertal 1979; Moran 1987: 476; Goren et al. 2004: 350; Finkelstein et al. 2006: site 86; Salem 2006: site 348.



69. Pottery from Kh. Yannun: 1. Krater, drk brn, LB; 2. Jar, gr, MB II; 3. 'Folded' CP, brn, MB II; 4, 8. Jar handles, brn, IA I; 5. Jug, brn, LB-IA I; 6. CP, brn, LB; 7. Jar, lt brn, MB II; 9. Sherd with bird dec, blk on rd, 'bi-chrome', LB I; 10. Bowl, yel, LB I-II; 11. Bowl, brn, MB II; 12. Jar with rope dec, yel, MB II; 13. Jug base, rd slip, MB II; 14. base, lt, LB.

Site 43: 16-21/60/1

E.P. 287

Israel grid: 1669 2106	Soil quality: 3
UTM grid: 7045 5969	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 287 m a.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name type: elevation point	Water source: 'Ein Kharubeh
Site type: small	(no. 147), 800 m distant
Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)	Road: Ya'bad-Ta'anach (C16),
Topography: ridge	1 km distant
Rock type: Judah group	Visibility: 3
Soil type: terra rossa	Date of visit: Jan. 1998; 41 sherds

A small site on the lower part of a broad ridge, extending from the Shaged School to Nahal Zavdon. It is a vantage point overlooking Nahal Zavdon and its sites.

The site has three parts:

1. The southern one contains remnants of two ruined buildings. Parts of walls made of medium-sized stones are visible. This seems to be the oldest part of the site; there may be remains of a farm here.
2. In the eastern part is a square tower, built of large stones, with a base about 5×5 m. It is about 1 m high, and seems to have been built later than part 1.
3. To the west and south of this tower are attached two irregular courtyards. They are built of medium-sized stones and one of them has remnants of an opening composed of two upright stones.

On the slope, north-east of the site, are many terraces and a round, igloo-shaped structure. About 50 m south of the site were found remains of a built road, belonging to the network of agricultural roads in the region.

An excavation was conducted at the site by Dar et al. (1986: 8–10). A farm was found and nearby a field tower, stone clearance piles, terraces, and installations for the production of oil and wine. It seems that there was a relationship between the farm and the settlement at Umm er-Riḥan (Site 36). At the farm's centre an asymmetric courtyard (about 15×10 m) was revealed, the entrance to which was from the east. On both sides of the yard rooms were built. The courtyard and the rooms were constructed of smoothed stones. Rock surfaces, sometimes smoothed, served as floors. The farm watchtower (outer dimensions 3.2×3.1 m, inner 1.6×1.6 m) was at least two storeys high. The finds were dated to the 1st century BCE.

Pottery: Hellenistic – 5%; Late Roman – 95%.

Previous surveys: None.

Additional Bibliography: Salem 2006: Site 342.



Site 44: 16-21/70/2

Qaṣr et-Tin

Israel grid: 1673 2107

UTM grid: 7050 5970

Elevation: 220 m a.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient, but not on map

Site type: building and courtyard

Area: 1.5 dunam (1500 sq. m)

Topography: ravine

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 2

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: 'Ein Kharubeh
(no. 147), 700 m distant

Road: Ya'bad-Ta'anach (C16),
700 m distant

Visibility: 2

Date of visit: Jan. 1998; 28 sherds

A structure and courtyards in a ravine, at the bottom of a ridge at E.P. 287, and above Wadi a-Sq'a. The site is located about 1.3 km south-east of 'Anin.

At the site is a central structure (a tower) and courtyards next to it. The base of the tower is 4.1×4.3 m, and it is preserved to a height of 4 m at the most (ten stone courses). Two storeys have been preserved: the lower one is complete, and includes an opening with two doorposts, a place for a door, and holes for the bolts. The bottom room has a corbelled dome roof.

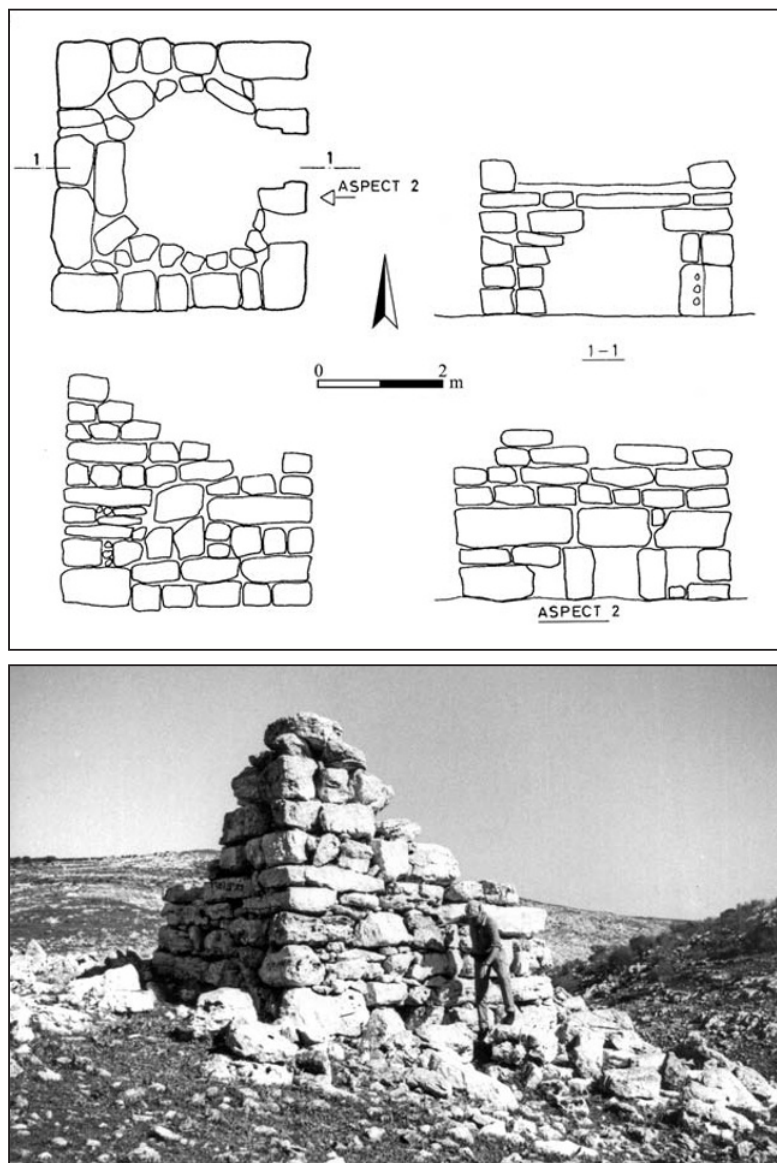
To the north and south of the structure, and adjacent to it, are two built courtyards with low walls made of medium-sized stones. Each is about 10×15 m, and between them to the north is another structure. A moderate amount of sherds was collected. To the north of the structure is a wine-press: 5×7 m pressing platform and a 2 m deep collection pit. Remnants of a road descending along the ridge at E.P. 287 were also found.

The tower was discovered in 1975 by surveyors of Umm Riḥan, and was published in their book, including cross-sections and a plan, but without any dating (Dar et al. 1986: 75-76).

Nearby (Israel grid 1672/2108) Dar notes (1986: 203) a complex of ten dams which were built in the wadi. The dams were dry-built of stone at 10–15 m intervals one after the other, up to 2 m high.

Pottery: Late Roman – 100%.

Previous surveys: Dar et al. 1986.



70. Qaşr et-Tin, plan and cross-sections, courtesy of the Riḥan Expedition (Dar et al. 1986: fig. 28), and photo of the tower, 1998, by M. Einav.

Site 45: 16-21/70/1

Ras eṣ-Ṣeiyafir

Israel grid: 1676 2100

UTM grid: 7053 5963

Elevation: 307 m a.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient, but not on map

Site type: small

Area: 1.5 dunam (1500 sq. m)

Topography: rocky hilltop

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 3

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: 'Ein Kharubeh
(no. 147), 1.3 km distant

Road: Ya'bad-Ta'anach (C16),
1.5 km distant

Visibility: 5

Date of visit: Jan. 1998; 105 sherds

A small site on a wide rocky hilltop in the ridges north of Tel Umm Zeid, about 2.3 km south-east of 'Anin.

At the site two similar structures were found, in different states of preservation. The better preserved eastern structure is square. It is a cell (5×5 m) sided by particularly large stone slabs, 1.5×0.3×1.0 m, standing on their short sides. The wall, of which these slabs comprise its inner facade, is 2–3 m thick. It has been completely preserved in the west, and partially



71. Photo of the Ras eṣ-Ṣeiyafir site, 1998. Note the standing stones. Photo: S. Hashman.

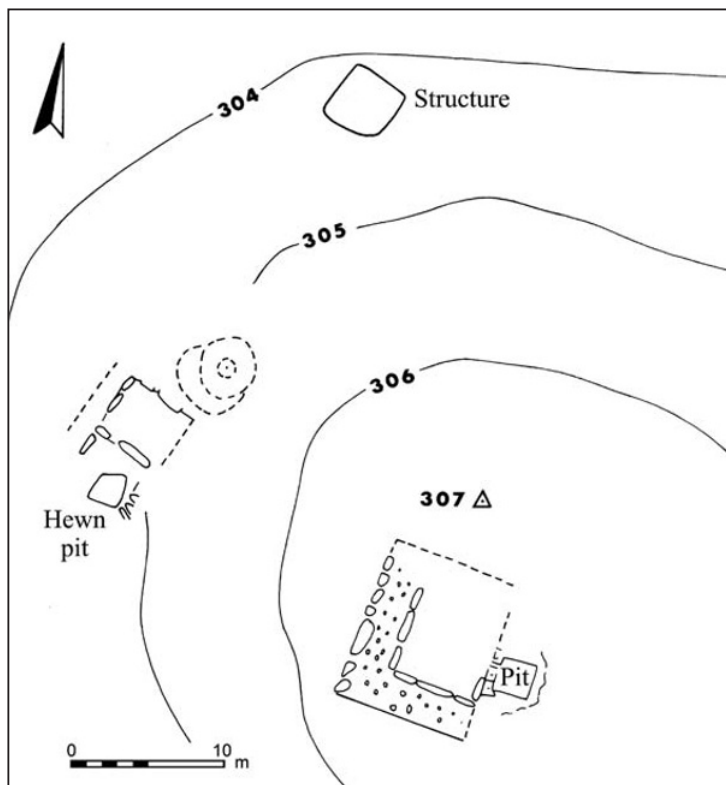
in the south. The outer parallel wall is made of medium-sized stones, and between the two walls is a fill of small stones.

The interior of the cell was found to be paved with stone slabs, and next to the eastern wall is a quarried pit or cave. About 20 m to the west is a similar structure, but less well preserved. A considerable sherd scatter, especially body sherds, was found. According to the residents, the name Şeyafir means 'large stones'.

The site is unusual in its structure, and at this time has no known parallels. It may have been an agricultural site with a specific purpose, or a cultic site.

Pottery: Hellenistic – 80%; Early Roman – 20%.

Previous surveys: None.



72. Plan of Ras eş-Şeyafir, 1998.

Site 46: 16-21/80/1

Tell es-Seruj (on British Survey map: Kh. Suruj)

Israel grid: 1687 2103	Soil quality: 2
UTM grid: 7063 5967	Cultivation: groves (partial)
Elevation: 273 m a.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: 2
Name type: appears on map as ancient	Water source: 'Ein Kharubeh (no. 147), 1.7 km distant
Site type: village on small ruin	Road: Ya'bad-Ta'anach (C16), 1.2 km distant
Area: 4 dunams (4000 sq. m)	Visibility: 7
Topography: rocky hilltop	Date of visit: July 1997; 19 sherds
Rock type: Judah group	
Soil type: terra rossa	

A small village on a ruin, in the hilly area west of el-Yamun and about 1.8 km north of 'Arraqah. The rocky hilltop is surrounded by an enclosure wall of large stones, 50 m by 40 m. The wall stands to a height of 1–1.5 m, and its north-west corner is especially well preserved. On the south-west corner of the enclosure there is a structure that juts out from the wall, which may have served as an entranceway. Around the site are a few sherds from the Roman period.

The enclosure and building manner are reminiscent of military structures from the Roman period (camp or fortress). From this spot there is a good view of the Umm el-Faḥm range and the wadis around it. Thus it may be a reasonable conjecture that this was a military site.

The British Survey notes "traces of ruins" (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 63).

Pottery: Late Roman – 100%.

Previous surveys: None.

Additional Bibliography: Salem 2006: site 320.

Site 47: 17-21/10/2

Umm ez-Zigan

Israel grid: 1701 2103	Soil quality: 6
UTM point: 7077 5967	Cultivation: olive grove
Elevation: 210 m a.s.l., 30 m b.s.a.	Cisterns: 1
Name type: ancient, but not on map	Water source: Bir 'Uthman (no. 146), 2 km distant
Site type: small	Road: Jatt-Ta'anach (A3), 2 km distant
Area: 0.5 dunam (500 sq. m)	Visibility: 3
Topography: slope	Date of visit: Jan. 1998; 30 sherds
Rock type: Judah group	
Soil type: terra rossa	

A small site on a slope on the hill of E.P. 238, in the hilly area about 1.5 km west of el-Yamun.

On the slope is a small structure from the Ottoman or British period. Around it are a sherd scatter and a cistern. In the Byzantine period one or two structures stood here.

Pottery: Byzantine–100%.

Previous surveys: None.



Site 48: 17-21/10/1

El-Yamun (on British Survey map: el-Yamon)

Israel grid: 1719 2102	Soil quality: 7
UTM grid: 7096 5966	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 180 m a.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: about 100
Name type: ancient Arab village	Water source: Bir es-Sabah (no. 21), 1 km distant
Site type: large village on ruin	Road: Jenin–Megiddo (A2), 2 km distant
Area: about 20 dunams (2 ha) – ancient core	Visibility: 3
Topography: small valley	Date of visit: 1998; 50 sherds
Rock type: Judah group	
Soil type: terra rossa	

A large Arab town in the inner, western, part of the Ta'anach Hills, in an area of low hills, about 1.5 km west of the fringes of the Jezreel Valley. The town, situated in a ravine between hills, now covers about 600–800 dunams (60–80 ha). Among these hills Tell el-Baṭn (Site 57), located south-west of the village and high above it, is prominent. In the centre of the modern village is the small ancient core, containing a few remains of a fortress or quarter surrounded by a wall, apparently from the Ottoman period or the Middle Ages. In this area are cisterns, hewn places, burial caves, and remains of ancient walls.

In the Medieval sources it is mentioned (in a document from 1156) as the estate of Dorf Janua. In 1596 the village was in the Jenin province, and contained 28 Moslem taxpayers. Out of a total of 15000 *aqia* paid as tax, there were 7800 for wheat, 1620 for barley, 998 for summer crops, 2982 for olives, and the rest for miscellaneous (Hütteroth and 'Abdulfattah 1977: 160). From this it is apparent that the principal agricultural crop was grain, which was apparently grown in regions of the Jezreel Valley.

Guérin (1969b: 225) describes, "At 7:20 (14 June 1870) we passed by a well named Bir es-Sab'a, an ancient name in memory of the name Abraham gave to one of the wells that he dug at the southern end of the Land of Israel. I have already described this well-known well... we continued on our way north-north-west and then north-west in a pleasant valley in which wonderful olive trees are grown, and as the way continued we found among them old fig trees as well. At 7:35 we reached Yamun, a village of 500 inhabitants which is divided into two quarters, each commanded by its own sheikh" [translated from French, A.Z.].

In the British Survey the place is described as: "El Yamon – A large village, with olives round it, standing on high ground, with a well on the east. This appears to be the Janna of the 'Onomasticon', 3 miles south of Legio; but the distance does not exactly agree, being 7 English miles." (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 46).

In the 1931 census there were 1836 residents and 371 inhabited homes. A hoard of coins from the Byzantine period was found (Vilnay 1968: 175).

According to Grossman (1986: 349), the residents relate that some of them came from Hauran and some from Egypt, and that settlement of the village took place at the time of Daher el-Omar (a claim that does not fit the sources).

In the opinion of Avi-Yonah (1976: 68), and contrary to the opinion of the British Survey (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 46), this site is to be identified as Janua in the Onomasticon (no. 544 – Taylor 2003). In our opinion

Janua is to be identified as 'Anin: see Chapter 2.

Pottery: Early Roman – 13%; Late Roman – 31%; Byzantine – 19%; Early Moslem – 10%; Middle Ages – 15%; Ottoman – 10%; Modern – 2%.

Previous surveys: None.

Additional Bibliography: Beyer 1940: 195; Dauphin 1998, III: site 79.



Site 49: 17-21/30/1

En-Naqaqir

Israel grid: 1738 2105

UTM grid: 7115 5970

Elevation: 170 m a.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient, but not on map

Site type: medium-sized

Area: about 8 dunams (8000 sq. m)

Topography: broad ridge

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: olive grove

Cisterns: 1

Water source: Bir es-Saba (no. 21),
1.2 km distant

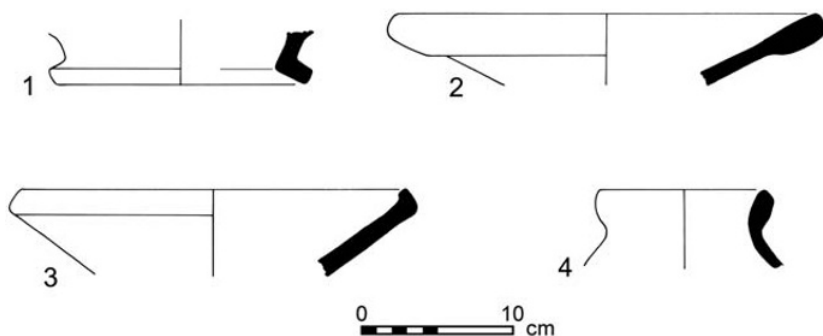
Road: Jenin–Megiddo (A2), 700 m
distant

Visibility: 6

Date of visit: a few visits in 1997 and
1998; 37 sherds

A site on a wide ridge in the hilly area between el-Yamun and Kafr Dan, about 1.2 km north of the latter. The ridge descends moderately eastward from a hilltop covered with olive trees (E.P. 208).

In the centre of the ridge, on an area between two long stone fences (to



73. Pottery from en-Naqaqir, all Pers: 1.Mortaria base, yel; 2-3.Bowls, gr; 4.Jar, gr.

the north and south) about 100 m apart, were found remains of structures that were almost completely dismantled. The building stones of the site had been concentrated into large piles by a bulldozer.

A blocked-up opening of a cistern and the entrance to a well-hewn burial cave were found. The entrance was about 2 m wide and 5 m deep. In the rock-cut opening was a sort of *dromos* and *arcusolium*, and an inner entrance was also visible. It is hard to establish whether the cave belonged to the original settlement, or is to be dated later.

The site is a small village from the Persian period, when the region flourished with many settlements.

Pottery: Persian – 100%.

Previous surveys: None.

Bibliography: Finkelstein et al. 2006: site 87.



Site 50: 16-20/49/1

Zaqzuq

Israel grid: 1644 2097

UTM grid: 7021 5959

Elevation: 432 m a.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.

Name type: as previously published

Site type: farm

Area: 2 dunams (2000 sq. m)

Topography: plateau

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: none

Water source: 'Ein es-Safra (no. 137),
1.2 km distant

Road: Ya'bad-Ta'anach (C16),
next to site

Visibility: 6

Date of visit: July 1997; 20 sherds

A farm on a rocky plateau, located about 1 km east of Umm Riḥan.

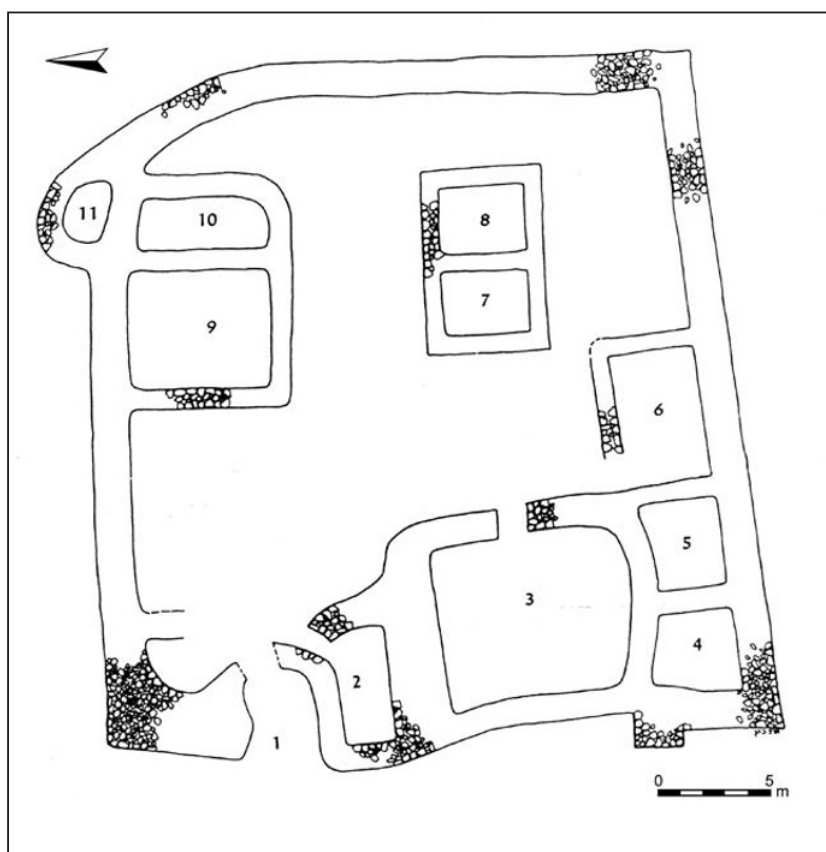
The farm is presently hidden within a thicket just east of the Nazlet-Zeid – 'Anin road (C16). It includes a large courtyard, 30×30 m, built of field stones. The wall surrounding the courtyard is preserved to 1 m in height, and is 1.8 m thick. The entrance is on the western side. Near the western side is a large room (no. 3 in fig. 74), whose entrance is from the courtyard. Next to it are three small rooms (nos. 4–6). Two other rooms (nos. 9, 10) are next to the north-eastern corner, and next to them is a sort of small tower built into the wall (no. 11). In the middle of the courtyard are two more

rooms next to each other (nos. 7, 8). In the opinion of the surveyors (Dar et al. 1986: 113), room no. 3 served as an animal pen, and rooms 9, 10 were workshops.

Salvage Excavations (Aizik and Peleg 2009c) of a field tower 300 m north-east of the site, revealed a rectangular structure (inside 2.6×2.4 m) built of field stones, with walls founded on the bedrock and preserved up to four courses high (1.5 m). Two phases of use were noted in the dig: the first dated to the Byzantine period, and the second was undated.

Pottery: in the site – Iron II (7th–6th cent. BCE) – 100%; in the salvage excavation – Byzantine – 100%.

Previous surveys: Dar 1982: 111; Dar et al. 1986.



74. Plan of Zaqzuq (Dar et al. 1986: fig. 49).

Site 51: 16-20/59/1

E.P. 431

Israel grid: 1658 2096	Soil quality: 7
UTM grid: 7035 5959	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 431 m a.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name type: nearest place	Water source: Bir ej-Jinneḥ
Site type: medium-sized ruin	(no. 154), 1.5 km distant
Area: 8 dunams (8000 sq. m)	Road: Ya'bad-Ta'anach (C16),
Topography: flattened hilltop	1 km distant
Rock type: Judah group	Visibility: 4
Soil type: terra rossa and brown forest	Date of visit: June 1997; 40 sherds

A site on a high broad hilltop in the region of Shaqed–Hinanit; between these two settlements and on the national watershed. Close by, to the west, is the junction next to the Shaqed regional school, and to the north is the road to Hinanit. There is a good view eastward to the area of 'Arraqah and el-Yamun, and northward to the villages of 'Anin and Umm el-Faḥm.

The summit of the hilltop has been cleared by heavy machinery while preparing the area for settlement. Only the foundations of houses built of field stones remain, as well as a surrounding wall on the southern part of the site, one stone thick, and about 50 m long. It can be surmised that the wall once existed on the other sides of the site as well, but was destroyed. In the centre of the site, near the fig tree, is an elevated place, perhaps indicating the existence of a central structure.

This is a Persian period village, founded on top of a small earlier Middle Bronze Age site.

Pottery: Middle Bronze II – 5%; Persian – 90%; Late Roman – 5%.

Previous surveys: The place was mentioned as a “farm” by the Umm Riḥan team (Dar et al. 1986: 113). Dar (1982: 112) who surveyed the place notes nearby (Israel grid 1658/2098) remains of a road with field towers at its sides.

Site 52: 16-20/69/1

Qaṣr el-Lejjah

Israel grid: 1671 2091

UTM grid: 7049 5954

Elevation: 330 m a.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient, but not on map

Site type: fortified farm

Area: 5 dunams (5000 sq. m)

Topography: broad ridge

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 4

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 3

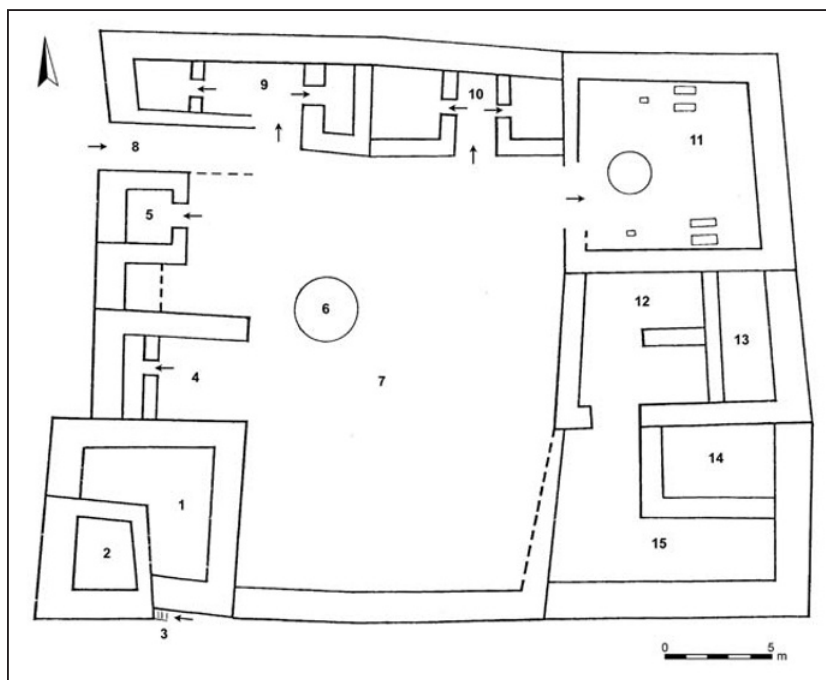
Water source: Bir ej-Jinneḥ
(no. 154), 2.2 km distant

Road: Ya'bad-Ta'anach (C16),
1.7 km distant

Visibility: 6

Excavated 1975, visited June 1997

A farm on a wide, rocky ridge, covered with *Pistacia* bushes, in the area of Shaqed–Riḥan–Hinanit. The farm and the structures connected with it are situated above the deep Wadi Khashab. Today the new industrial area of Shaqed is nearby to the west.



75. Plan of Qaṣr el-Lejjah (courtesy of the Riḥan Expedition, Dar et al. 1986: fig. 48).

The farm is rectangular, measuring 27×36 m. It is built in the format of a central courtyard with various wings around it. The dry construction is made of large, slightly worked stones. The well-preserved farmhouse rises in certain sections to a height of 5–6 m (the western tower). A description of the main buildings follows (the numbers and description are according to the original plan of Dar et al. 1986: fig. 48; here fig. 75):

1. A square, two-storey tower, rising to a height of 6 m, located in the south-western corner of the courtyard. The bottom storey measures 9×9 m, and the top storey 5×5 m. The tower has two entrances: from the outside (via a stairway) and from inside the courtyard. Possibly the farm owners lived in this tower.
6. A large rock-cut plastered cistern in the centre of the courtyard (7), 3 m in diameter. There are two more cisterns outside the structure.
8. Main entrance, 2 m wide, in the south-western corner.
- 9, 10. Rooms along the northern wing.
11. Oil press with its installations in the north-eastern corner of the 8×8 m hall, in which were preserved (at the time of excavation) a lower crushing press (about 2 m in diameter) and stands for oil press beams. After excavation, the press was stolen at unknown later date, with a tractor that breached the oil press room.
- 12–15. Rooms in the eastern wing.

Next to the north-eastern corner, on the outside, a square tower, 5×5 m, was found, perhaps used as an outlook point onto the lower areas. Slightly west of the central courtyard is another courtyard, which was almost totally destroyed when the industrial area was built. On the surface of the ridge are many field towers and agricultural installations, which apparently belong to the farm.

According to the excavators, the farm was built during the Hellenistic period (3rd–2nd century BCE), and functioned until the 1st century CE. A very limited exploratory excavation was carried out at the site, in particular to establish the corners of the structure for the purpose of drawing the plan and cleaning the cisterns.

In 1999 an excavation was conducted in the adjacent industrial zone by Aizik (Aizik and Peleg 2009a). Five field towers were unearthed, spread over a moderate ridge and its slopes descending from south to north. The finds were dated to the Byzantine period, and it is likely that the towers were part of the agricultural layout of the Umm er-Riḥān settlement (Site 36) about 3.5 km to the west.

Pottery (Summary of the different surveys and excavations): Hellenistic; Early Roman; Byzantine.

Previous surveys: Dar 1982: 111.

Additional Bibliography: Dar 1986: 10–12, 174, 175.



Site 53: 16-20/89/1

Tell Umm Zeid (on British Survey map: Kh Anin)

Israel grid: 1680 2093

UTM grid: 7057 5956

Elevation: 320 m a.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient and on map

Site type: fortified tell

Area: 7 dunams (7000 sq. m)

Topography: flat, mountainous
saddle

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 5

Cultivation: none

Cisterns: 1

Water source: 'Ein Kharubeh
(no. 147), 2 km distant

Road: Ya'bad–Ta'anach (C16),
2.2 km distant

Visibility: 5

Date of visit: June 1997; 60 sherds

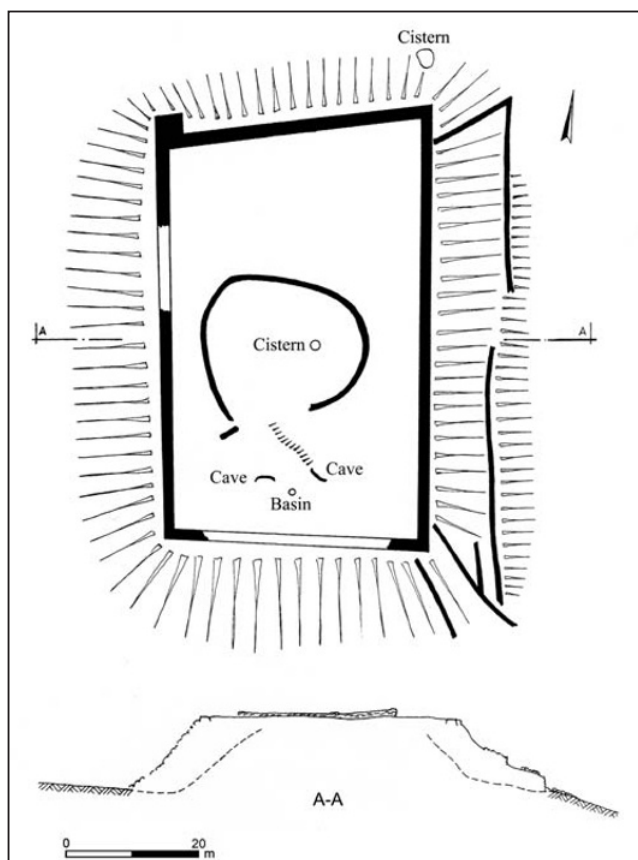


76. Bird's eye view of Tel Umm Zeid, looking north, 1997. Photo: M. Weinberg.

A fortified tell rising up from a flat, particularly rocky saddle, 1 km north-west of the village of 'Arraqah. To the west of the rocky saddle an extremely sharp slope descends to Wadi el-Khashab.

The tell measures about 70×87 m. At the upper end is a supporting wall enclosing a rectangular area 37×67 m. The wall is about 1.5 m thick and is well built of medium-sized stones. It has been preserved on all sides except the south, where only its corners remained. The supporting wall rises to a height of 10–12 m above the flat saddle upon which the site is located. It appears that there was a rocky hill here, around the top of which this wall was constructed.

This wall was strengthened on the outside by an earthen ramp, which descends to the level of the saddle at an angle of about 45 degrees. To



77. Plan and cross-section of Tel Umm Zeid, 1998.

the east of the ramp, additional walls were built, similar to terraces, to strengthen its slope. In this way a high square platform was created, whose top part is levelled. The platform was apparently ascended from the north-east and south-east.

On top of the platform are rock-cut caves and other quarried places, walls without any clear plan and with some filling. In the middle of the summit is a cistern surrounded by an elliptical surface, made of crushed white limestone. The cistern and surface are modern (according to the local residents, built "40 years ago").

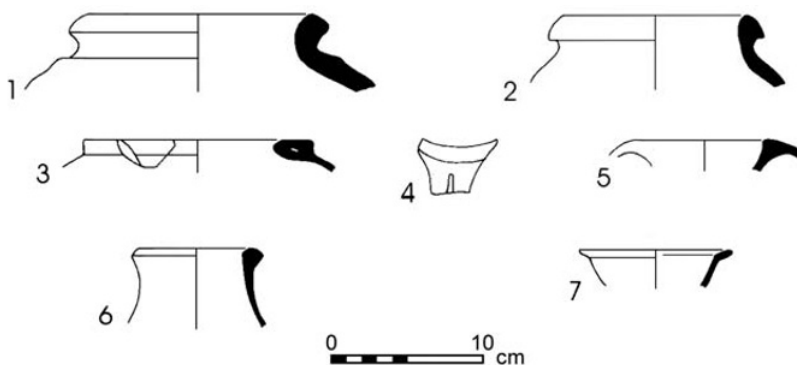
On the British Survey map "traces of ruins" are mentioned here (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 57); it is possible that the surveyors did not reach the site.

Tel Umm Zeid is a surprising site, both in its location and in its character. It is a rectangular site with a ramp that was built in Middle Bronze Age II in an especially rocky area, far from roads and water sources. It is difficult to determine what settlement type it belongs to, but in any case it is an example of the masonry of this period.

Pottery: Middle Bronze II – 80%; Persian – 15%; Roman – 5%.

Previous surveys: None.

Additional Bibliography: Salem 2006: sites 23, 343.



78. Pottery from Tel Umm Zeid: 1-2 .Jars, lt, Pers.; 3.HM, gr, Pers.; 4.Jug handle, ER;
5.Jug, yel, Pers.; 6.Jug, gr, Pers.; 7.Juglet, lt, MB II.

Site 54: 17-20/09/1

Khirbet Ibn 'Amr (Kh. Amr, Kh. Abu 'Amir; on British Survey map: Abu Amir)

Israel grid: 1704 2095	Cultivation: field crops and groves
UTM grid: 7081 5959	Cisterns: 30
Elevation: 245 m a.s.l., 25 m a.s.a.	Water source: Bir 'Uthman (no. 146), 1.2 km distant
Name type: historic site on map	Road: Jatt-Ta'anach (A3), 3 km distant
Site type: tell and large ruin	Visibility: 5
Area: 30 dunams (3 ha)	Dates of visits: Aug. 1979, Feb. 1980, July 1997; 84 sherds
Topography: hilltop on ridge	
Rock type: Mount Scopus group	
Soil type: rendzina and brown forest	
Soil quality: 4	

A large ruin on a long range running generally south-east–north-west, located about 1.5 km south-west of el-Yamun. The ruin is in the hilly area between the Dothan Valley and the Jezreel Valley, and the el-Yamun–'Arraqah road passes to its south. Today it is entirely cultivated and trees grow there.

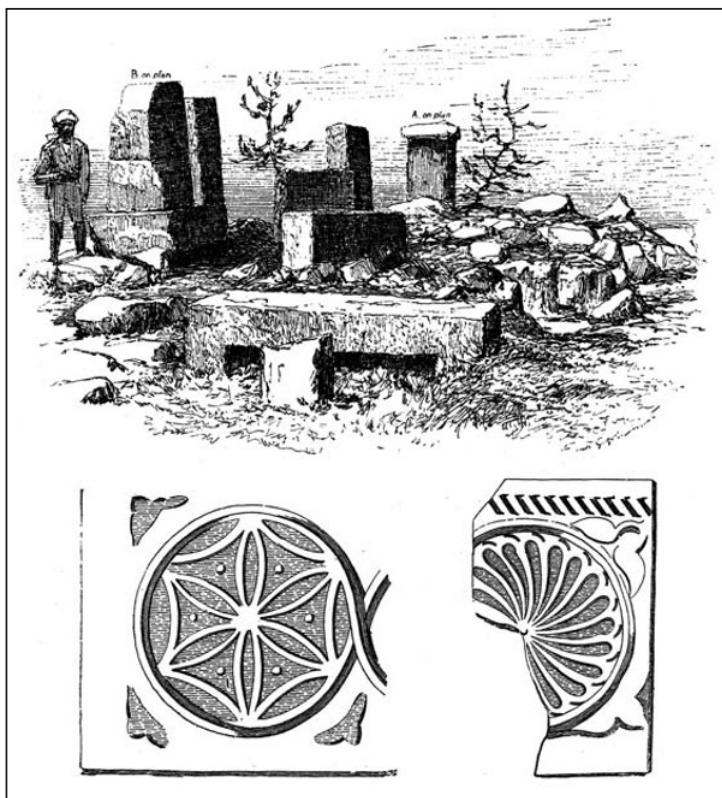
In the centre of the site (E.P. 245) is a 'high place' constructed of large cut ashlar. It measures about 8×10 m and is three courses high. Next to the 'high place' are three large evergreen oak trees, and the tomb of Sheikh Salamah (a small structure). All over the area, on the hilltop and the ridge, are many walls and building stones, including a lintel *in situ*, ashlar, a cistern, and quarried places. In the southern part of the site an exceptionally large, rectangular structure was found measuring 6×15 m, whose plan and parts are well preserved. It may be assumed that this was one of the most important buildings in the settlement. Its walls are built of field stones mixed with many ashlar, and many of its stones are embellished: two lintels decorated in Corinthian style, carved pillar sections, Corinthian capitals, etc. The whole area, for 30 m around the central structure, contains other smaller structures built in a similar style. One of the carved stones seems to have served as a sundial.

The southern slope of the site apparently served as an industrial area. Many oil press lower stones were found, as well as many sections of stone arches and various parts of installations for industrial processing of agricultural produce.

On the eastern part of the site, the ancient tell has apparently been

preserved. The remains of an earthen rampart were discovered here, upon which sherds from former periods (Iron Age and Persian) were found.

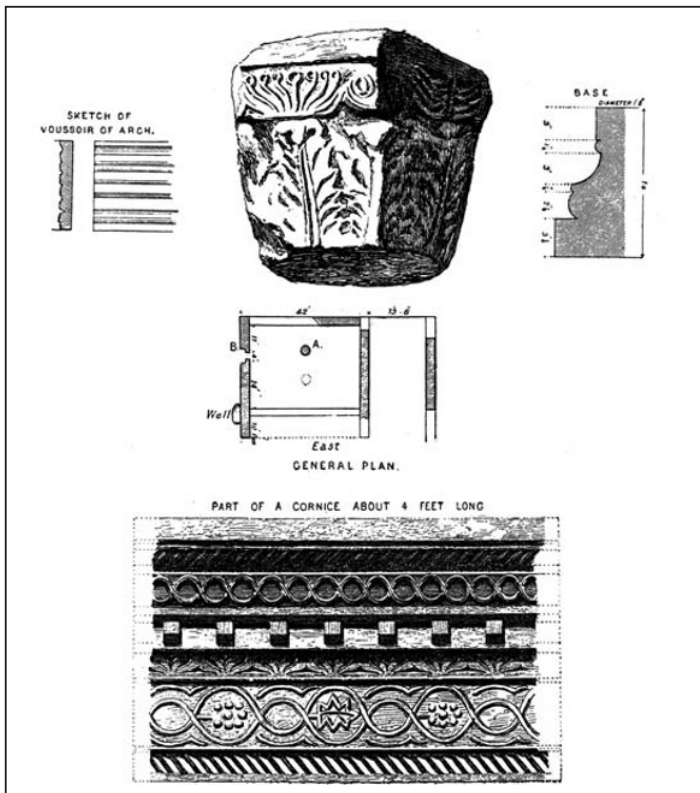
The description of the British Survey members who visited the site on 21 Sept. 1872 is as follows: "Khurbet Abu 'Amir – A small building was here found, on the top of a flat hill, and near it a structure resembling an altar. A road leads up from the south. The walls measured 42 feet north and south, and 39 feet east and west; on the south wall was a doorway 4 feet wide, 11 feet from the west wall inside. There was another wall running east and west 13½ feet north of the north wall. A pillar shaft, 4 feet 10 inches in circumference, stands within the building; on the south a lintel stone lies on the ground. The masonry is well dressed, of good size, not drafted. The largest stones are in the jambs of the doorway. The average size is about 1 foot in height, from 1 to 2 feet in length. Voussoirs belonging to a circular arch



79. Above: Sketching of monuments at Khirbet Ibn 'Amr, Sept. 1872;
Below: architectural reliefs (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 55).

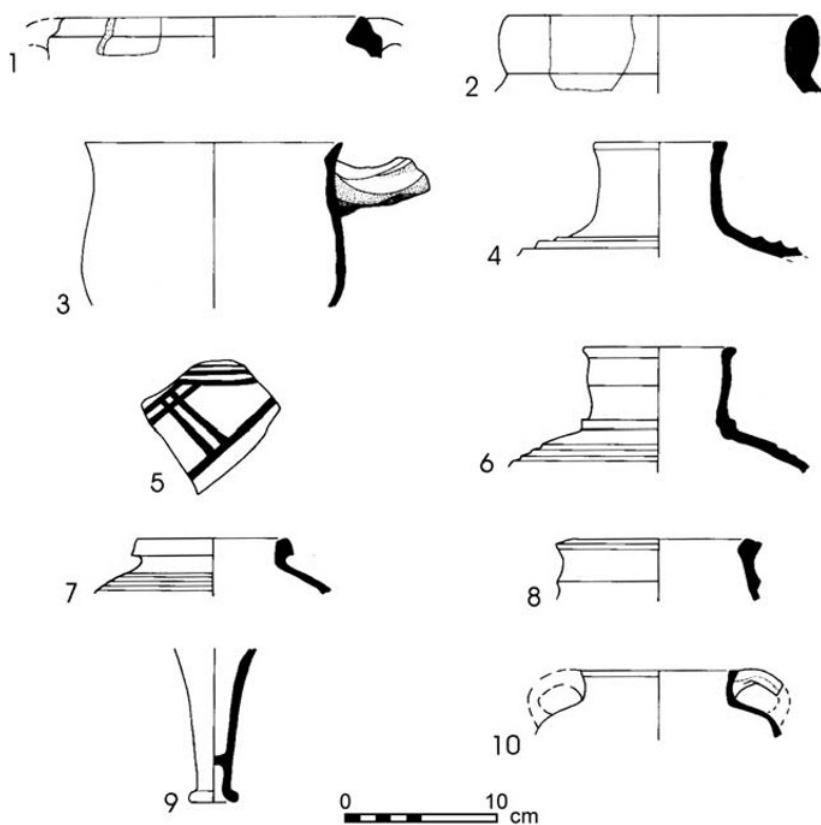
were found strewn about, and there are remains of foundations, apparently of houses, round the building. There are also cisterns cut in rock, and lined with pink cement full of powdered pottery mixed in the lime. One of the voussoirs was ornamented with mouldings in low relief. The base of a pillar, 1 foot 8 inches diameter, 14 inches high, was found, and a capital, much battered. Remains of a cornice, very elaborately carved, and of slabs of stone, also ornamented, were copied. The ornamentation is of debased character." (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 54–56).

A separate letter by Tyrwhitt-Drake in Oct. 1873 states: "In one ruin—Khirbet Abu 'Amir—near Kefr Kud, we found the ruins of a building. It is probably a small temple, and there are appearances as though it were in *antis*. The stones are too much scattered and decayed for satisfactory examination. Lieutenant Conder and my-self have made sketches of the ornamentation,



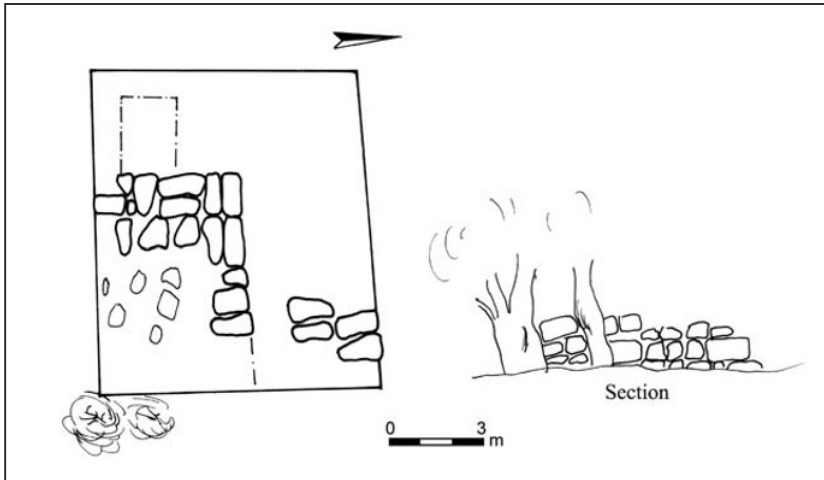
80. Architectural reliefs from Khirbet Ibn 'Amr
(Conder and Kitchener 1882: 56).

which is much over crowded on the cornices. All around are ruins of houses and traces of a road up to them, on which are strewn the voussoirs of a circular arch with plain mouldings. The usual rock-hewn cisterns exist, but lined with a very hard pinkish cement. This colour arises from the finely coloured pottery mixed with the lime. Nearby is a pit hewn in the soft rock, in which I was told water still collects and remains, even in the summer, after abundant rains. Beside it are some fine ballut trees, and solid platform 35ft. by 30ft. of large roughly-hewn stones. The object of this erection is not evident; whether sacrificial or merely an oil-press is impossible to say. The tomb of Sheikh Selameh now stands upon it." (Tyrwhitt-Drake 1873: 31).



81. Pottery from Khirbet Ibn 'Amr: 1.CP, brn, IA II; 2.Pithos, lt, IA I; 3.Jug, lt brn, Byz.; 4, 6.Jars, blk/rd, Byz.; 5.Jug, purple on lt, MA.; 7.Jar, lt. LR; 8.Jar, gr, IA II, 9.Unguentarium, lt, Hel.; 10.CP, brn, LR.

A letter from 1873 written by Conder on the same matter states: "The supposed temple at Abu Amr has been noticed by Mr. Drake in his last report. I send drawings of the details, a small plan, and a sketch, showing the present strata of the ruin. The floor is a couple of feet below the general level of the rubbish, so that possibly excavation might bring some inscription connected with the edifice to light; but some time would be required to investigate the



82. Plan and cross-section of the 'high place' at Khirbet Ibn 'Amr, 1998.



83. The 'high place' at Khirbet Ibn 'Amr, looking west, 1979. Photo – A. Zertal.

place properly. The details are pretty well preserved and are of a debased style of art, resembling some of the first century work at Jerusalem.” (Conder 1873: 12).

Porath's description (1968: no. 12) is similar in principle to the British Survey's, without any additions. In our visit to the site we were unable to find any Middle Bronze Age sherds, which Porath had described. The ceramic find of the other periods was similar.

Pottery: Iron I – 5%; Iron II – 5% (both primarily in the eastern part of the site); Persian – 15% (all over the site); Late Roman – 30%; Byzantine – 30%; Early Moslem – 5%; Middle Ages – 10%.

Previous surveys: Porath 1968: no. 12.

Additional Bibliography: Dauphin 1998, III: site 54; Salem 2006: site 4.



Site 55: 17-20/09/2

Khariqet er-Ras

Israel grid: 1708 2096

UTM grid: 7085 5960

Elevation: 235 m a.s.l., 15 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: small

Area: 2.3 dunams (2300 sq. m)

Topography: hilltop

Rock type: 'Avdat group

Soil type: brown forest

Soil quality: 5

Cultivation: groves

Cisterns: 1

Water source: Bir Birein (no. 23),
1.5 km distant

Road: Jatt-Ta'anach (A3), 3 km
distant

Visibility: 3

Date of visit: Aug. 1979; repeated
visits Jan. 1998; 50 sherds

A site on a round hilltop in the hilly region west of the Jezreel Valley, 1 km west of the centre of the village of el-Yamun. South of the site the road passes from el-Yamun to 'Arraqah, and east of it is Wadi el-Gharbi. From the site is a fine view southward to the high range of el-Kharaiyyeq, and eastward to the fringes of the Jezreel Valley.

The site is cultivated today and olive trees grow there. Apparently the borders of the ancient site were along an earthen rampart surrounding the hilltop. Within the rampart, which is 1 m high and irregular in shape, are remains of a wall and structures made of large uncut stones. Remains of

this wall are clearly visible in various places along the ramp. The cornerstone in the north-east corner is especially large and prominent.

The site's buildings were dismantled and their stones are to be found in the fences made of cleared stones. On the south-eastern slope of the hill is an abandoned, modern structure. Presumably the cisterns in the area of the ruin are of a later date and are connected with cultivation of the orchards.

This is a site fortified by a rampart, built in Middle Bronze Age II style, which possibly served as a fortress for watching over the springs or road. The main importance of the place was in the Late Bronze Age; it may have had some connection with nearby Tel Ta'anach.

Pottery: Middle Bronze IIB – 45%; Late Bronze I – 25%; Late Bronze II – 25%; Persian – 5%.

Special find: Ceramic stopper bearing stamp marking, possibly Middle Bronze Age II.

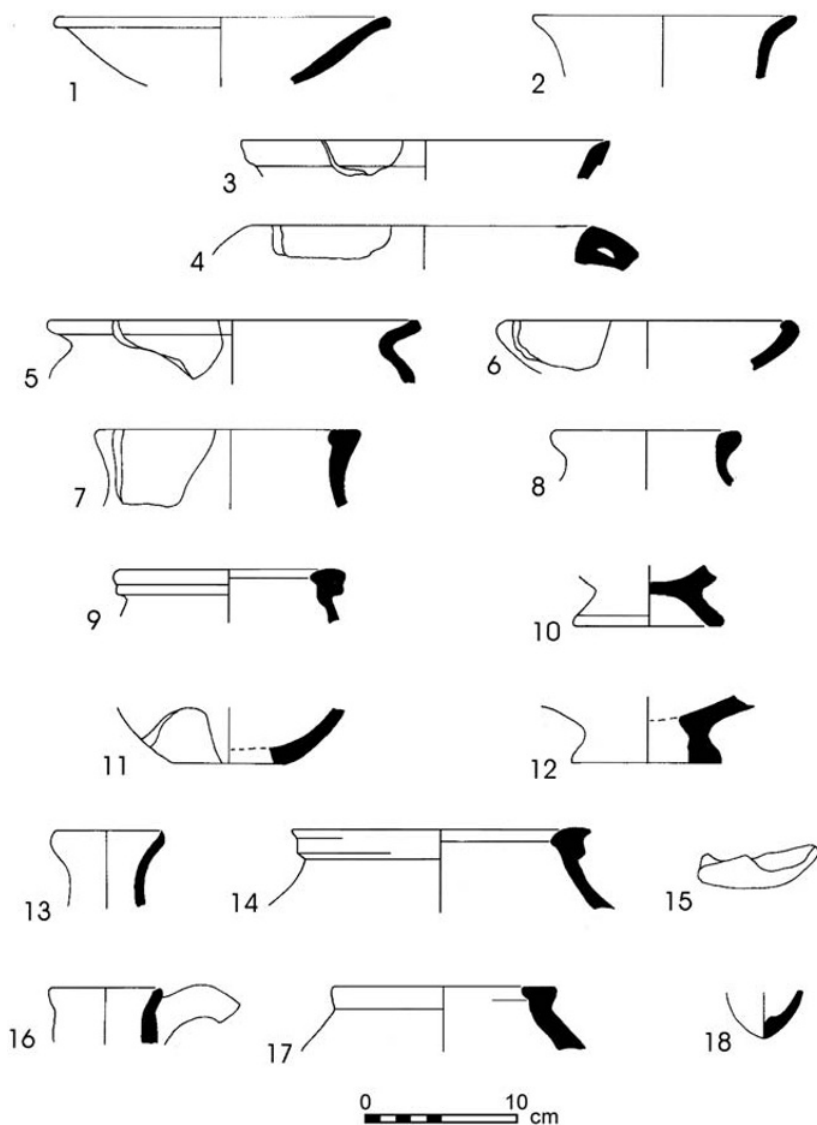
Identification: Its identity has been proposed as Ginti Ašna from el-Amarna letter no. 319; see Chapter 2.

Previous surveys: None.

Bibliography: Goren et al. 2004: 349; Salem 2006: site 95.



84. The site of Khariqet er-Ras, facing north, 1979.



85. Pottery from Khariqet er-Ras (all MB II except nos. 1-3, 8): 1-2. Bowls, yel, LB; 3. CP, brn, LB; 4. CP, dk brn; 5. CP, yel; 6. Bowl, yel; 7. Jar, yel; 8. Jar, gr, Pers.; 9. Jar, brn; 10. Bowl base, lt; 11. Jug base, yel; 12-13. Jugs, yel; 14. Jar, lt; 15. lamp, yel; 16. Jug, yel; 17. Jar, lt; 18. Juglet base, yel.

Site 56: 17-20/09/3

En-Naqqarah

Israel grid: 1707 2092	Soil quality: 4
UTM grid: 7084 5956	Cultivation: groves
Elevation: 195 m a.s.l., 5 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name type: nearest place	Water source: Bir Birein (no. 23), 1.3 km distant
Site type: structure	Road: Jatt-Ta'anach (A3), 3 km distant
Area: 0.5 dunam (500 sq. m)	Visibility: 2
Topography: slope	Date of visit: Aug. 1979; 19 sherds
Rock type: 'Avdat group	
Soil type: brown forest	

A small site on the southern slope of a rocky hill, north of the el-Yamun–'Arraqah road, situated in the hilly region between the Dothan and Jezreel Valleys.

On the slope of the hill (called en-Naqqarah and next to Khariqet er-Ras) is one solitary structure, three walls of which remained. The northern wall is gone. The three remaining walls are built of one course of field stones, each about 7 m long. Next to the structure a few sherds were found.

Pottery: Middle Bronze II – 100%.

Previous surveys: None.

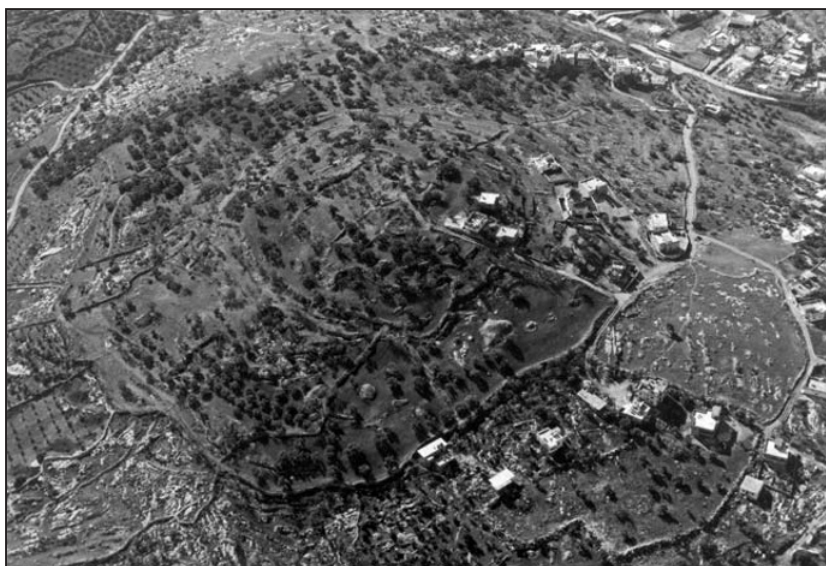
Bibliography: Salem 2006: site 239.



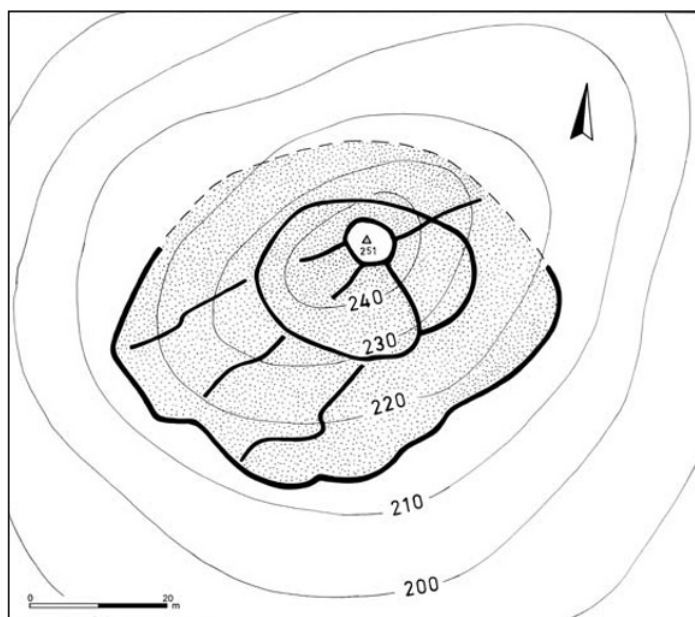
Site 57: 17-20/29/1

El-Batn (Baṭn es-Sema)

Israel grid: 1724 2095	Cultivation: olive groves
UTM grid: 7101 5960	Cisterns: 8
Elevation: 251 m a.s.l., 80 m a.s.a.	Water source: Bir es-Saba (no. 21), 300 m distant
Name type: ancient, but not on map	Road: Jenin–Megiddo (A2), 2.5 km distant
Site type: fortified tell	Visibility: 7
Area: 80 dunams (8 ha)	Date of visit: July 1979, Oct. 1979, Feb. 1998; 174 sherds
Topography: high summit	
Rock type: Mount Scopus group	
Soil type: terra rossa	
Soil quality: 6	



86. Bird's eye view of the tell at el-Baṭn, facing north, 1997. Note the 'upper city'.
The houses in the background are those of the village of el-Yamun.
Photo: M. Weinberg.



87. The plan of the tell at el-Baṭn, 1998.

A large fortified tell on a high summit in the hilly region between the Dothan and Jezreel Valleys, about 800 m south-east of the centre of the village of el-Yamun. The tell is surrounded by unpaved roads, and olive and almond trees grow at the bottom. In the east is the spring of Bir es-Saba and in the west – that of 'Ein el-Balad.

The tell seems to be fortified by two walls, an inner and an outer one. The inner wall surrounds the summit of the tell, which extends about 10 m above the broad surface of the top. The area of this 'upper city' is about 20 dunams (2 ha) and in its centre is an elevated acropolis that is surrounded by a wall. Beneath the acropolis is a 30 m wide area whose boundary is marked by an inner wall. The inner city inside this wall is divided into courtyards by walls of field stones, in which building stones from the structures have been integrated. Despite the intensive clearing of stones, many walls are still discernible *in situ*, as well as an abundance of sherds.

The outer wall encompasses the summit and the wide shoulders of the hill. Especially prominent is a 150 m wide shoulder that extends south and east. The height of the wall here, in several places, is 5 m, and it is easily visible. In this area, too, there are courtyards made of cleared stones, walls *in situ*, piles of stones, etc. All over the tell are various cut installations and cisterns.

This is a central tell in this region, corresponding in size and settlement to Ta'anach, Hefher, Dothan, etc. Judging by the pottery evidence, it was settled mainly during the Iron Age and Persian periods.

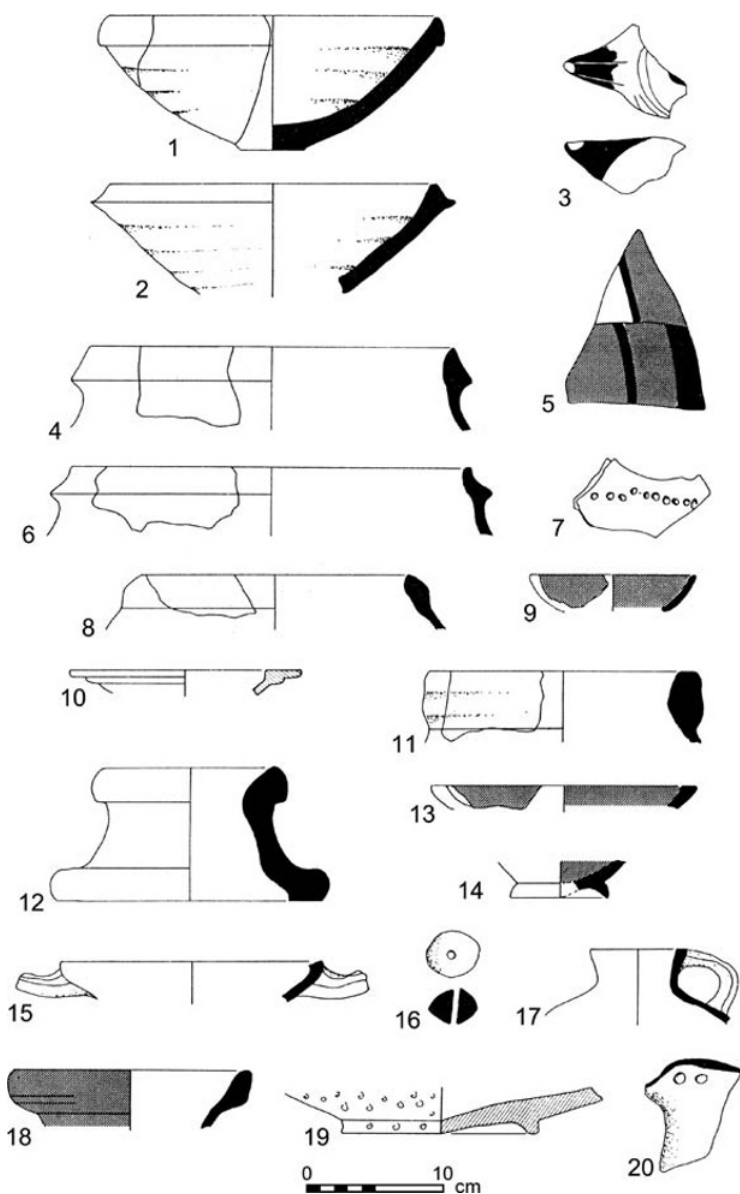
When he visited here, Porath mistakenly called the place Khirbet Burin; he found "a large ruin at the top of a high hilltop" (Porath 1968: no. 13).

Pottery: Middle Bronze IIb – 5%; Iron I – 15%; Iron II – 10%; Iron III – 5%; Persian – 50%; Hellenistic – 5%; Roman-Byzantine – 5%; Modern – 5%.

Identification: It is proposed to identify this site as Bethomestaim or Bet Homotaim, an important city in the Book of Judith (4:6; 15:4) which was close to Betuliyah. The tell fits this identification, and apparently Bemese-lis from the Hellenistic period was also here (War I, iv, 6): see discussion in Chapter 2.

Previous surveys: Porath 1968: no. 13.

Additional Bibliography: Grintz 1957: 104; Finkelstein et al. 2006: site 67; Salem 2006: site 44.



88. Finds from el-Baṭn: 1-2. Bowls, gr, Pers; 3. Lamp, brn and blk, Hel.; 4, 6. CP, brn, IA Ib; 5. Imported jug, brn/blk on cream colour, Pers.; 7. Dec on jug, yel, Pers; 8. Krater, brn, IA II; 9, 13-14. Bowls, wh and rd, IA II; 10. Small bowl, blk marble; 11. Pithos, brn, IA I; 15. 'Frying pan', gr, Byz; 16. ceramic weight; 17. Jug, brn, LR; 18. Jar, rd slip, IA II; 19. Bowl, basalt; 20. Jar handle with incisions, IA I.

Site 58: 17-20/39/1

Khariq esh-Shams

Israel grid: 1732 2092	Soil quality: 7
UTM grid: 7109 5956	Cultivation: olive grove
Elevation: 170 m a.s.l., 18 m b.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name type: nearest place	Water source: Bir el-Gharbi (no. 22), 500 m distant
Site type: medium-sized	Road: Jenin–Megiddo (A2), 2 km distant
Area: 2.8 dunams (2800 sq. m)	Visibility: 1
Topography: slope and ridge	Date of visit: July 1979; 60 sherds
Rock type: Mount Scopus group	
Soil type: terra rossa	

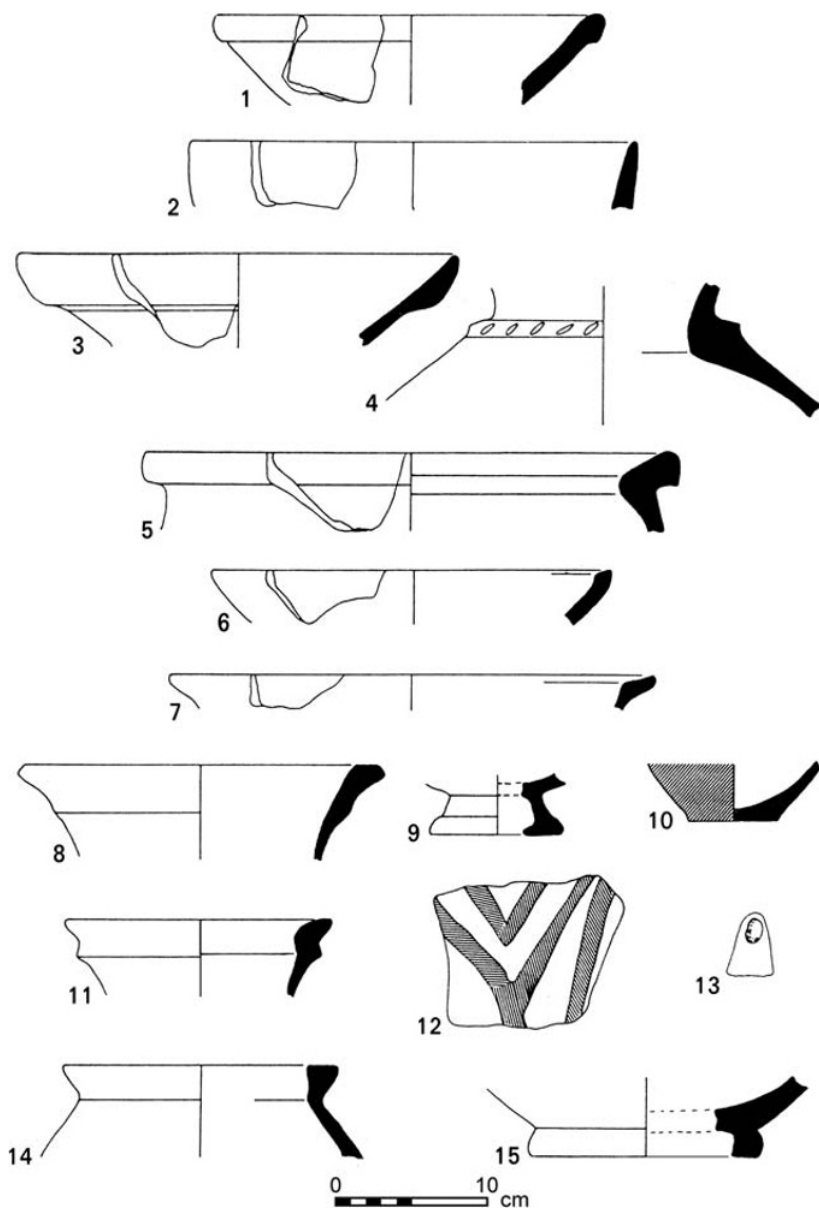
A site in the region of the low hills north of the Dothan Valley, about 800 m west of Kafr Dan. Near it is a water source (Bir el-Gharbi) as well as a junction of unpaved roads: one leading to Kafr Dan and the Jezreel Valley, the second to the village of el-Yamun, and the third to the Dothan Valley.

In a natural depression, bordered in the north by a low cliff, sherd scatters and some architecture were found. The depression measures about 80×100 m. In its inner part, adjacent to the cliff, sherds from the Bronze Age were discovered, while in the outer part Persian sherds were found. In this depression, created by drastic erosion, and perhaps improved by man, was a site composed of several structures. It can be surmised that the residents of the region used the natural character of the place for defence. The transition to intensive agricultural cultivation that followed the Persian period left sparse architecture on the site. Most of the structures were dismantled, and the sections of walls were found cannot be integrated into a plan.

Pottery: Middle Bronze IIb – 30%; Late Bronze – 10%; Persian – 60%.

Previous surveys: None.

Bibliography: Finkelstein et al. 2006: site 73; Salem 2006: site 94.



89. Pottery from Khariq esh-Shams: 1. Bowl, yel, Pers; 2. CP, dk brn, MB II; 3. Motaria, greenish, Pers; 4. Jar, yel, MB II; 5. Krater, yel, Pers; 6. Bowl, yel, MB-LB; 7. CP, brn, MB-LB; 8, 11. Jars, yel, MB II; 9. Jug base, yel, MB II; 10. Jug base, brn, MB II; 12. Dec on jar, rd on yel, MB II; 13. Lamp, yel, Pers; 14. Jar, yel, Pers; 15. Krater base, brn, MB II.

Site 59: 17-20/49/1

Kafr Dan (on British Survey map: Kefr Adan)

Israel grid: 1741 2093	Soil quality: 7
UTM grid: 7117 5958	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 180 m a.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: about 50
Name type: ancient	Water source: Bir el-Gharbi (no. 22), 1 km distant
Site type: village on ruin	Road: Jenin–Megiddo (A2), 1.2 km distant
Area: 5 dunams (5000 sq. m)	Visibility: 3
Topography: ravine	Date of visit: 1980; 70 sherds
Rock type: Mount Scopus group	
Soil type: terra rossa	

A medium-sized village on a ruin in the western fringes of the Jezreel Valley, about 3.5 km north-west of Jenin. A few structures, burial caves and installations have survived from the ancient village.

The place is absent from the Medieval sources. In the 1596 census it was in the S'ara province, and had nine Moslem taxpayers. The town paid tax of a quarter of its harvest, totalling 6000 *aqia*. Of this, 3860 *aqia* was paid for wheat and barley, and 640 for olives (Hütteroth and 'Abdulfattah 1977: 159).

Guérin (1969b: 225) writes: "At 6:52 we reached the orchards of Kafr Adan. Mostly fig and olive trees grew there, surrounded by gigantic cactus hedges. The village by this name sits on a hill, and has 300 inhabitants. I saw a section of a pillar and a few ashlar that looked ancient." [translated from French, A.Z.].

The British Survey members wrote: "Kefr Adan – A village of moderate size on the slope of the hills, built of stone, with olives below, and a well on the west. This appears to be the Kefr Outheni of the Talmud, a village on the borders between Samaria and Galilee (Mishnah Gittin, vii. 7). It might, perhaps, also be the En Haddah of Issachar (Josh. xix. 21), from its proximity to En Gannim, the town immediately preceding this name on the list." (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 45).

In the census of 1931 there were 603 residents and 135 inhabited houses (Vilnay 1968: 207).

Pottery: Roman-Byzantine – 35%; Early Moslem – 20%; Middle Ages – 20%; Ottoman – 25%.

Identification: Preservation of the name, and the location and findings allow it to be identified as Kfar Othnay, on the borderline between the

Galilee and Samaria: see Chapter 2.

Previous surveys: None.

Additional Bibliography: Klein 1939: 95-96; Salem 2006: site 138.



Site 60: 16-20/78/1

Khirbet Wadi el-Khashab

Israel grid: 1679 2082	Soil quality: 6
UTM grid: 7056 5946	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 335 m a.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name type: ancient, but not on map	Water source: Bir 'Uthman (no. 146), 1.7 km distant
Site type: farm	Road: Ya'bad-Ta'anach (C16), 1.5 km distant
Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)	Visibility: 4
Topography: hilltop	Date of visit: Dec. 1978; 31 sherds
Rock type: Mount Scopus group	
Soil type: terra rossa	

A small site at the edge of a ridge, on a hilltop, in the hilly region north of Dothan Valley, about 1 km west of the village of 'Arraqah. Next to it, to the west, is an unpaved road branching off the road to Kh. eṭ-Ṭurm and leading to 'Arraqah.

Parts of a structure, of which the western and northern walls have been preserved, were found at the site. On the upper part, the remains of a round structure were also found. A rock-cut installation in a poor state of preservation was found on the western part of the hill. Around the structure was a sherd scatter from the Persian period. Presumably the structure was part of an agricultural farm of the type common to the region.

Pottery: Persian – 100%.

Previous surveys: None.

Site 61: 16-20/98/1

'Arraqah (in the British Survey – Araqah)

Israel grid: 1692 2085	Soil quality: 6
UTM grid: 7069 5950	Cultivation: none
Elevation: 280 m a.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: 33 (in ancient core)
Name type: appears on map, but not as ancient	Water source: Bir 'Uthman (no. 146), 700 m distant
Site type: village on tell	Road: Ya'bad–Ta'anach (C16), 2.5 km distant
Area: 15 dunams (1.5 ha)	Visibility: 4
Topography: hilltop	Date of visit: Nov. 1979; 50 sherds
Rock type: Judah group	
Soil type: rendzina and brown forest	

A small scattered Arab village on a hilltop and on a slope, in the hilly area north of the Dothan Valley.

In the ancient core are about 15 structures, apparently from the Ottoman period. This core, standing on an ancient tell, is arranged in the form of a fortress, and was apparently fortified in the Middle Ages and afterwards. Here and there are ancient walls, quarrying and water cisterns. Parts of the ancient centre are still exposed, and on the slopes below them there is accumulated waste that includes many sherds.

The site does not appear in the Ottoman census of 1596. The members of the British Survey found "a village of moderate size on a hill-side, with a well on the south" (Conder and Kitchener 1882: 44). In 1931 there were 219 residents and 36 inhabited houses (Vilnay 1968: 330). Grossman (1986: 345) estimates that the village has been in existence about 250 years, and was apparently founded by or under the auspices of the 'Abd el-Hadi family. Some of the residents came from the Bet Jibrin (Hebron) region, and some from Jordan.

The continuity of settlement points to a much earlier date of establishment. It is possible that in the Ottoman census the name was garbled to Arana.

Pottery: Late Roman – 10%; Byzantine – 20% Early Moslem – 10%; Middle Ages – 30%; Ottoman – 10%; Modern – 20%.

Previous surveys: Porath 1968: no. 15.

Additional Bibliography: Dauphin 1998, III: site 92; Salem 2006: site 33.

Site 62: 16-20/98/2

Khirbet Bir 'Uthman

Israel grid: 1697 2082

UTM grid: 7074 5946

Elevation: 260 m a.s.l., 30 m a.s.a.

Name type: ancient, but not on map

Site type: large ruin

Area: 14 dunams (1.4 ha)

Topography: hilltop

Rock type: Judah group

Soil type: rendzina

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: groves

Cisterns: 8

Water source: Bir 'Uthman (no. 146),
at site

Road: Ya'bad-Ta'anach (C16), 3 km
distant

Visibility: 6

Date of visit: July 1997; 46 sherds

A large site on a round, broad hilltop, terraced and covered with olive trees, east of the village of 'Arraqah. Between the site and the village is a ravine containing an unpaved road leading from Tel es-Seruj and Kh. Ibn 'Amr.

The site extends over most of the hilltop, the southern part of which is now almost completely built up. At the top is a kind of raised acropolis, which has been preserved and which contains many building stones, remnants of walls, cisterns and sherds. No whole buildings have survived, as they were dismantled to make room for orchards. In the western and southern parts of the hilltop is an especially high (6–8 m) built terrace. It may have been used as the site's defence wall.

The site also descends to the saddle to its east. Judging by the sherds, houses must also have stood on the lower part of the western slope at E.P. 293.

Pottery: Early Roman – 8%; Late Roman – 30%; Byzantine – 50%; Early Moslem – 12%.

Previous surveys: None.

Site 63: 17-20/08/1

E.P. 293

Israel grid: 1700 2085

UTM grid: 7076 5952

Elevation: 293 m a.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.

Name type: elevation point

Site type: medium-sized ruin

Area: 8 dunams (8000 sq. m)

Topography: high hilltop

Rock type: 'Avdat group

Soil type: rendzina

Soil quality: 6

Cultivation: groves

Cisterns: 3

Water source: Bir 'Uthman (no. 146),
200 m distant

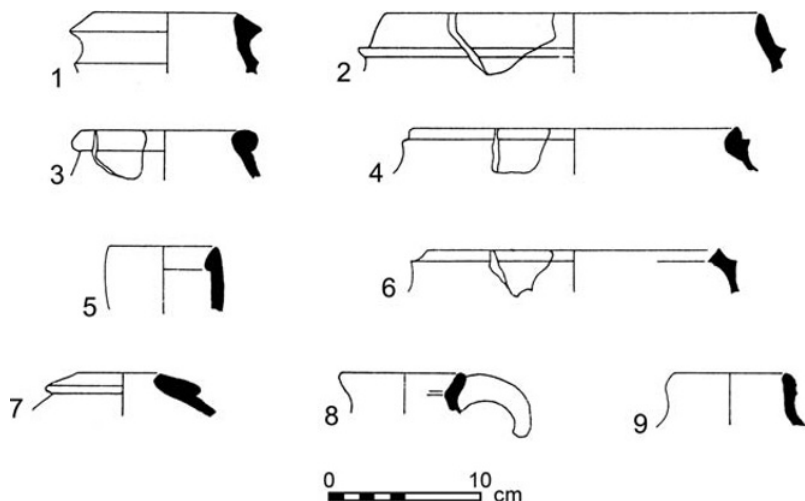
Road: Ya'bad-Ta'anach (C16), 3.3 km
distant

Visibility: 6

Date of visit: Dec. 1978; April 1997;
35 sherds

A site at the summit of a high round prominent terraced hilltop, about 1 km east of the village of 'Arraqah, and north of the 'Arraqah-el-Yamun road. There are fine views to the north and south from here.

The upper part of the hilltop has high steps, particularly in the east. This creates an optical illusion of a fortified tell, but apparently the origin of these steps is actually terraces for cultivation. In the fields between the terraces is a very light sherd scatter, indicating several structures. No evidence



90. Pottery from E.P. 293: 1.Jar, gr, IA II; 2.CP, brn, IA Ic; 3.Jar, gr, IA II-Pers; 4.CP, brn, IA II; 5.Jar, lt, IA II (?); 6.CP, brn, IA I-II; 7.HM, gr, IA II; 8.Jug, brn, IA II; 9.Jar, yel, IA II-Pers.

was found of a fortifying wall. In the upper area of the hilltop are several cisterns and rock-cut installations.

Pottery: Iron Age I-II – 65%; Persian – 15%; Hellenistic – 10%; Early Roman – 10%.

Previous surveys: None.



Site 64: 17-20/18/1

Khirbet Birein (B)

Israel grid: 1716 2087

UTM grid: 7094 5951

Elevation: 210 m a.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: sherd scatters

Area: 1 dunam (1000 sq. m)

Topography: ravine

Rock type: alluvium

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 4

Cultivation: groves and field crops

Cisterns: none

Water source: Bir Birein (no. 23),
500 m distant

Road: Jatt-Ta'anach (A3), 3 km
distant

Visibility: 1

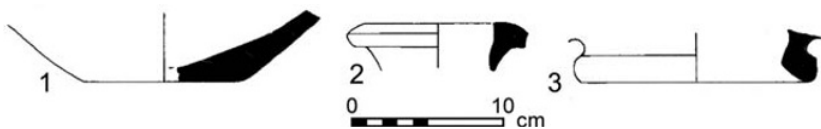
Date of visit: July 1979; 19 sherds

A small site in a region of low hills, north of the Dothan Valley, about 2 km south-west of el-Yamun, and about 200 m south of the large ruin of Khirbet Birein (A).

In a ravine, known as Khallet Sallam, which is 50 m wide and close to the built path from el-Yamun to el-Hashmiyeh, sherd scatters were found over an area of about 1 dunam (1000 sq. m). Remnants of buildings were not found, but it is likely that they were dismantled in order to cultivate the land. Apparently a structure or two once stood here.

Pottery: Persian – 100%.

Previous surveys: None.



91. Pottery from Kh. Birein (B), all from Pers: 1. Bowl base, gr; 2. Jug, yel; 3. Mortaria base, yel.

Site 65: 17-20/18/2

Khirbet Birein (A)

Israel grid: 1717 2084	Soil quality: 4
UTM grid: 7094 5949	Cultivation: groves
Elevation: 275 m a.s.l., 15 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: 2
Name type: known as ancient, but not on map	Water source: Bir Birein (no. 23), at site
Site type: large ruin, small town	Road: Jatt-Ta'anach (A3), 2.5 km distant
Area: 11 dunams (1.1 ha)	Visibility: 2
Topography: ridge on slope	Date of visit: June 1979; 64 sherds
Rock type: 'Avdat group	
Soil type: brown forest	

A large ruin at the edge of a steep ridge descending northward from the high range of el-Kharaiyyeq in the hilly area between the Dothan Valley and the Jezreel Valley, and 1.5 km south of the village of el-Yamun. North of the site is a small, internal valley, and west of it is a hilltop, E.P. 242. The ruin is a vantage point overlooking the hilly area to the north.

The area of the site is cultivated and planted with almond trees. Many walls were found *in situ*, but complete structures could not be identified, having been destroyed during the cultivation process. The built walls are made of well-cut field stones. There are a few architectural items, carved in floral and geometric designs (e.g., egg-and-dart, leaves and flowers, etc.), scattered both on the site itself, and primarily on the path leading to Bir Birein, the water source of the site.

On the eastern slope of the site's ridge, which is oriented generally north-south, there is a burial area with niches cut for graves. At least one cave was found open, containing two *loculi*. Above the entrance is a square cut recess, where apparently there was once an inscription.

In the western part of the ruin were found remains of a quarry, containing an unfinished sarcophagus that was abandoned before it was completely quarried.

Bir Birein, the water source, is an especially large fountainhead, which is now clogged up. It is about 7 m deep. The shaft descending to the fountainhead is built with well-cut stones, and above it is a stone arch which covered the entrance.

The place was a medium-sized town during the Roman-Byzantine periods, similar in character to Khirbet Ibn 'Amr nearby, which excels in carved

architectural items.

Pottery: Early Roman – 10%; Late Roman – 20%; Byzantine – 70%.

Previous surveys: None.



Site 66: 17-20/38/1

‘Ein Ḥajjeh

Israel grid: 1734 2088

UTM grid: 7110 5953

Elevation: 160 m a.s.l., 35 m b.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: medium-sized

Area: 7.5 dunams (7500 sq. m)

Topography: wide ravine

Rock type: alluvium cover

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 8

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: none

Water source: ‘Ein Ḥajjeh (no. 24),
at site

Road: Jatt–Ta’anach (A5), at site

Visibility: 1

Date of visit: July 1979; April 1988;
122 sherds and flint items

A site in an open field in the ravine of Wadi Ḥasan and near the road passing through it, just south of its connection to Wadi Rahal about 500 m west of Kafr Dan.

At the site the wadi widens, and east of the channel is a very broad ravine. To its east towers Jebel Mellah, and to its west is the area of es-Sahlat. The site extends over a long narrow strip between the two hills and along the wadi. In this strip, in which the houses of the site once stood, there are many stones. Another part of the settlement extended over a step to the south, but in the east a low rock cliff limits the area. Neither fortifications nor walls have survived. Apparently the walls were dismantled to enable cultivation of the land, but scattered throughout the strip are many sherds, flint tools, and basalt items.

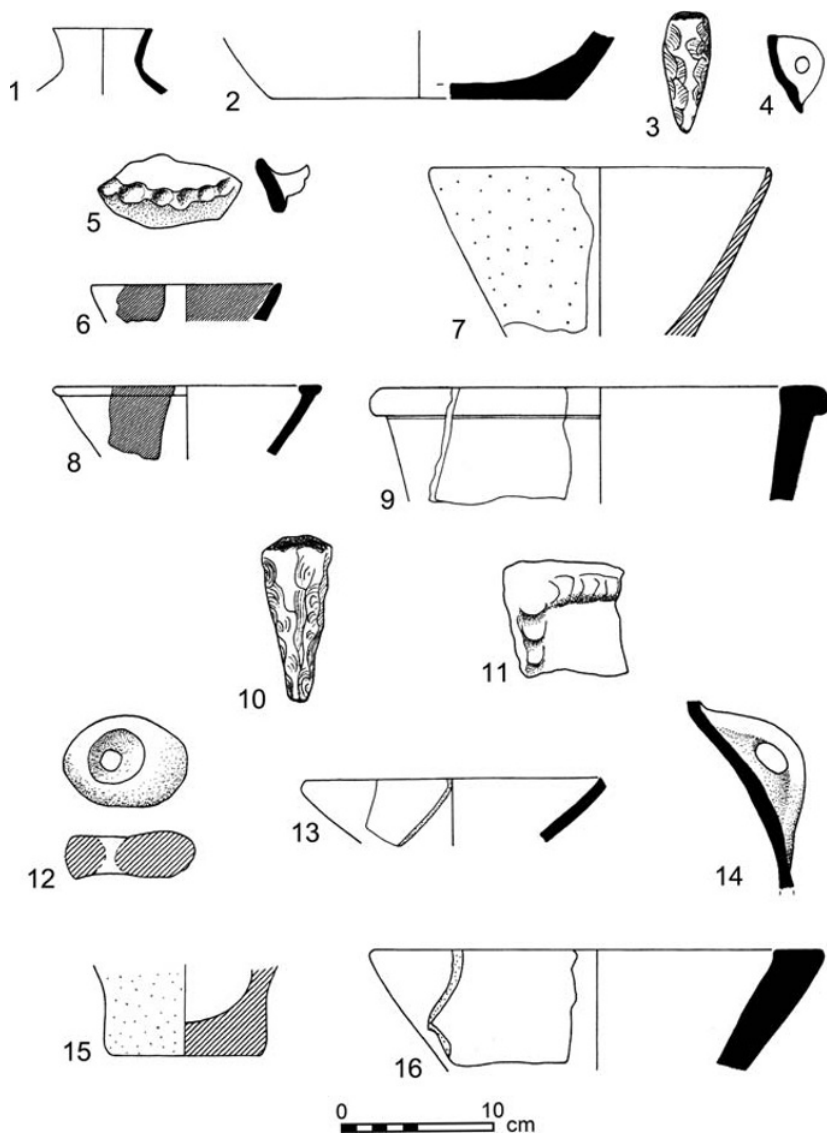
This site owes probably its existence to the abundant water sources in the region.

Pottery: Chalcolithic – 100%.

Flint and basalt find: Many Chalcolithic adzes and basalt items (bowls and mortars).

Previous surveys: None.

Bibliography: Finkelstein et al. 2006: site 68.



92. Finds from 'Ein Ḥajjeh, from the Chalcolithic period: 1.Jug, lt; 2.Jar base, lt; 3, 10.Adzes, flint; 4.Lug handle, lt; 5.Ledge handle, lt; 6, 8.Bowls, rd on lt; 7.Bowl, basalt; 9.Jar, lt; 11.Rope dec, dk; 12.Weight, basalt; 13, 16.Bowls, lt; 14.Handle, lt; 15.Bowl base, basalt.

Site 67: 17-20/38/3

Es-Sahlat (B)

Israel grid: 1733 2085

UTM grid: 7110 5954

Elevation: 180 m a.s.l., 20 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: enclosure and military camp (?)

Area: 5 dunams (5000 sq. m)

Topography: edge of slope in valley fringes

Rock type: alluvium

Soil type: brown forest

Soil quality: 7

Cultivation: olive grove

Cisterns: 3

Water source: 'Ein Hājjeḥ (no. 24), 300 m distant

Road: Jatt-Ta'anach (A5), 300 m distant

Visibility: 2

Date of visit: June 1979; June 1997; 48 sherds

A large enclosure, apparently bearing a military character, in the hilly area near the Wadi Ḥasan road between the Dothan and Jezreel Valleys, about 1.5 km south-east of el-Yamun.

The site is located in an open space, somewhat elevated and overlooking the road. This is a rectangular enclosure with the western wall crooked. The length of the sides is 60 m (north and south) and 75 m (east). The course of the western wall is only partially clear.



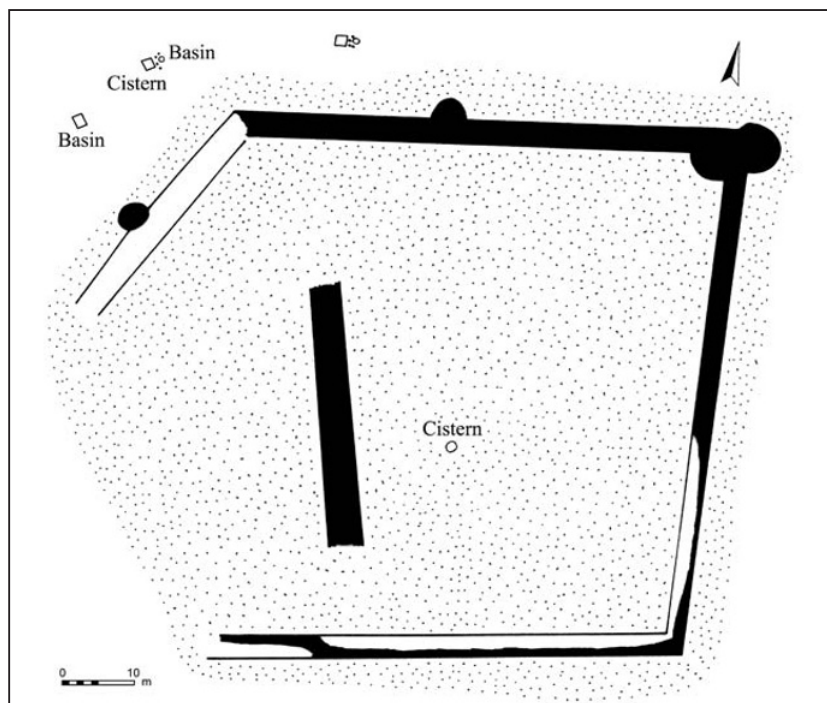
93. The wall and northern tower at es-Sahlat (B), 1997. Photo: M. Einav.

The site is fortified by a wall about 4 m thick, built of small and medium-sized field stones, which are well preserved in the northern part. This was apparently the original thickness of the entire wall, which surrounds the enclosure on the north, east, and south.

At the north-eastern corner of the enclosure an entrance tower with a diameter of 4 m has been preserved to a height of 2 m. A second semi-circular tower, with a diameter of 4 m, was found half-way along the northern side of the enclosure. Another tower belonging to the enclosure was located on the western part, where only sections of the wall were found. The eastern wall, which was well preserved, is now 4 m high.

In the centre of the site another wall was found, 30 m long and a 4 m thick. This wall perhaps formed part of a central structure that stood inside the enclosure. Apparently the southern part of the structure was part of the site's wall, or it may have been fortified by another wall whose possible remains were discernible on the surface. Aside from the above, no other structures were found.

Installations and cisterns were found in the northern part of the site



94. Plan of the enclosure at es-Sahlat (B), 1997.

outside its walls. Another cistern was found in the middle of the site.

A considerable number of sherds, solely from the Persian period, are scattered about.

Pottery: Persian – 100%.

Identification: It appears that the site was a fortified military camp from the Persian period. It is possible that it played a part in the siege on the city of Betuliyah in the Book of Judith, which according to our reconstruction took place in this region: see Chapter 2.

Previous surveys: None.

Bibliography: Finkelstein et al. 2006: site 70.



Site 68: 17-20/38/4

Es-Sahlat (A)

Israel grid: 1734 2083

UTM grid: 7111 5948

Elevation: 215 m a.s.l., 10 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: medium-sized

Area: 5.2 dunams (5200 sq. m)

Topography: edge of ridge near river
valley

Rock type: alluvium

Soil type: brown forest

Soil quality: 7

Cultivation: olive grove

Cisterns: 2

Water source: 'Ein Ḥanuni (no. 157),
300 m distant

Road: Jatt-Ta'anach (A5), 500 m

distant

Visibility: 2

Date of visit: June 1979; 41 sherds

A medium-sized site at the edge of a ridge that descends eastward from el-Kharaiyyeq Range to Wadi Ḥasan, about 1.5 km south-west of Kafr Dan.

The location of the site is on the northern upper slope of the ridge, overlooking the narrow valley of Wadi Ḥasan and the spring of 'Ein Ḥajjeh. At the site remains of five to eight structures were found *in situ*, made of field stones; some of whose stones had been removed during cultivation of the land. To the south of the site are two rock-cut wine vats and openings of two cisterns. There was a medium-sized sherd scatter.

Pottery: Byzantine – 100%.

Previous surveys: None.

Site 69: 17-20/38/2

Jebel Mellah

Israel grid: 1738 2087	Soil quality: 8
UTM grid: 7115 5952	Cultivation: olive grove
Elevation: 205 m a.s.l., 15 m a.s.a.	Cisterns: none
Name type: nearest place	Water source: 'Ein Ḥajjeh (no. 24), 300 m distant
Site type: farm	Road: Jatt-Ta'anach (A5), 400 m distant
Area: 0.5 dunam (500 sq. m)	Visibility: 3
Topography: ridge	Date of visit: July 1979; 39 sherds
Rock type: Mount Scopus group	
Soil type: terra rossa	

A small site on the high southern part of the Jebel Mellah Range, to the east of and above Wadi Ḥasan, and about 500 m south-west of the centre of Kafr Dan. The Jebel Mellah range is one of the ranges between the Dothan and Jezreel Valleys.

At the site are the remains of one large, solitary structure, 18×30 m. The structure was entirely covered by cleared stones; it was in an olive orchard and its plan was thus hard to discern. The walls were well built of large partially cut field stones. Apparently a courtyard adjoined the structure. Close to the building and its courtyard were a rock-cut wine vat, 1.5×2 m, and a few quarried places of various types.

The Jebel Mellah site is similar in character to many farms that were scattered through the region during the Persian period. They usually include a central structure, courtyard, cistern, and various installations. These farms characterize this period, one of the culminations of settlement expansion in this area.

Pottery: Persian – 100%.

Previous surveys: None.

Bibliography: Finkelstein et al. 2006: site 69.

Site 70: 17-20/38/6

Bir Ḥanuni

Israel grid: 1737 2085

UTM grid: 7113 5949

Elevation: 180 m a.s.l., 30 m b.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: sherd scatter and structure

Area: 3 dunams (3000 sq. m)

Topography: ravine

Rock type: alluvium and 'Avdat group

Soil type: alluvium

Soil quality: 8

Cultivation: groves and field crops

Cisterns: 2

Water source: 'Ein Ḥanuni (no. 157), at site

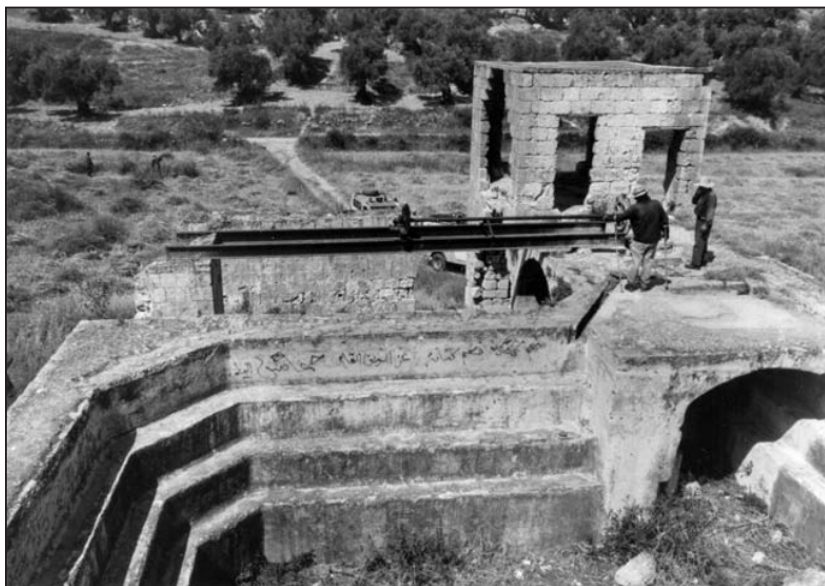
Road: Jatt-Ta'anach (A5), at site

Visibility: 2

Date of visit: Sept. 1997; 30 sherds and flint tools

A sherd scatter and a modern structure in a ravine of Wadi Ḥasan.

At the place where the ravine widens and close to the spring of 'Ein Ḥanuni a sherd scatter and flint tools were found in a field. A complex comprising a two-storey house, a diesel-powered pumping station next to it, and a pool about 10×10 m and 3 m deep, was established in the 1930s.



95. The structure and pool at Bir Ḥanuni, facing west. The structure is from the 1930's. The Chalcolithic site is in the valley in the background. 1998. Photo: M. Einav.

The construction is of good quality. An aqueduct brings the water to the structure, which also contains wells. North of the structure are additional buildings on the slope, made of small stones without mortar. According to the testimony of a local person, the place was set up by a wealthy family from Kafr Dan, which had moved to 'Ein Ḥanuni and made a living from growing vegetables and a citrus grove in the ravine. In 1937 their small son was killed when he was caught in the diesel engine belt and drawn into the motor. Following this tragedy the family left the area.

Pottery and flint: Chalcolithic – 100%. A few modern sherds and Mar-seilles roof tiles near the complex of the house and pool.

Previous surveys: None.

Bibliography: Finkelstein et al. 2006: site 72.



Site 71: 17-20/38/5

Nab'at Wadi Ḥasan

Israel grid: 1736 2081

UTM grid: 7113 5945

Elevation: 175 m a.s.l., 0 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: sherd scatter

Area: 1.6 dunams (1600 sq. m)

Topography: ravine

Rock type: alluvium

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 7

Cultivation: field crops

Cisterns: none

Water source: Nab'at Wadi Ḥasan
(no. 25), at site

Road: Jatt-Ta'anach (A5), at site

Visibility: 1

Date of visit: June 1979; 42 sherds

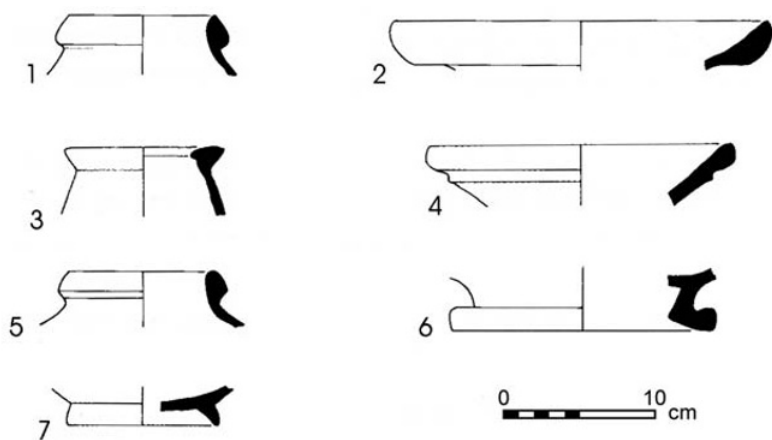
A small site in a deep ravine at the junction of Wadi Ḥasan and a ravine coming from the east. The site is located 1.5 km south of Kafr Dan and near the Wadi Ḥasan road.

At the site considerable concentrations of sherds close to the spring were found. The water source, Nab'at Wadi Ḥasan, is now blocked, but apparently it formerly served as an important source for travellers on the road. Near it was a Persian period settlement, whose buildings were completely dismantled during cultivation of the land. The place is marked on the British Survey map (Sheet VIII), with no remarks on the ancient site.

Pottery: Persian – 100%.

Previous surveys: None.

Additional Bibliography: Finkelstein et al. 2006: site 71.



96. Pottery from Nab'at Wadi Ḥasan, all Pers: 1.Jar, lt gr; 2, 4.Bowls, yel and gr;
3, 5.Jars, gr; 6.Mortaria base, lt; 7.Bowl base, lt.

Site 72: 17-20/48/1

Ed-Darajjeh

Israel grid: 1743 2084

UTM grid: 7120 5949

Elevation: 245 m a.s.l., 50 m a.s.a.

Name type: nearest place

Site type: sherd scatter

Area: 1.6 dunams (1600 sq. m)

Topography: hilltop on
mountainous plateau

Rock type: Mount Scopus group

Soil type: terra rossa

Soil quality: 8

Cultivation: olive grove

Cisterns: 1

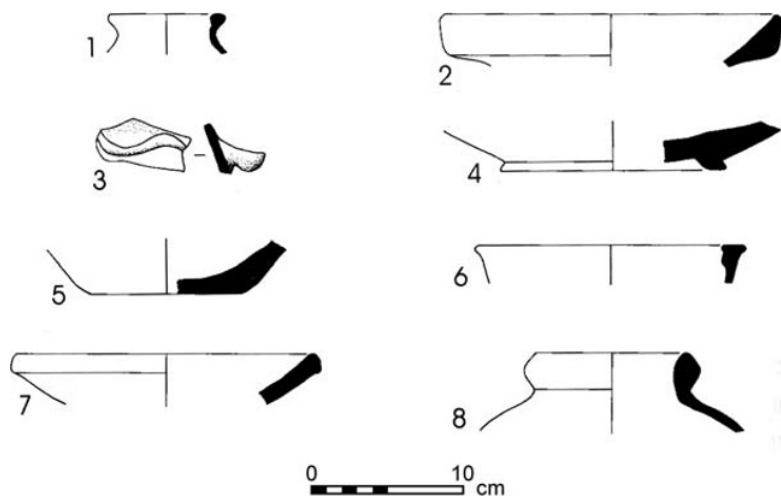
Water source: 'Ein Ḥanuni (no. 157),
500 m distantRoad: Jatt-Ta'anach (A5), 1 km
distant

Visibility: 5

Date of visit: June 1979; Sept. 1997;
40 sherds

A site on a high hilltop (E.P. 245) in the ed-Darajjeh ridge, in the hilly region between the Dothan and Jezreel Valleys, about 1 km south of Kafr Dan.

On the hilltop is a ruined Arab house, apparently from the Ottoman period, and next to it is a courtyard surrounded by a stone wall. The eastern part of the courtyard contains a round structure about 4 m in diameter (it is unclear whether it belongs to the structure), and south of the ruined house is a cistern. Under the structure is a large cave used for dwelling, containing remains of silos and storerooms built into the cave walls. In and



97. Pottery from ed-Darajjeh: 1. Juglet, brn, ER; 2, 4. Bowl and Bowl base, yel, Pers.; 3. Handle, lt, MB II (?); 5. Bowl base, lt gr, Pers.; 6-7. Bowls, yel, Pers.; 8. Jar, gr, Pers.